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(54) ADJUSTABLE ELECTRICAL BOX

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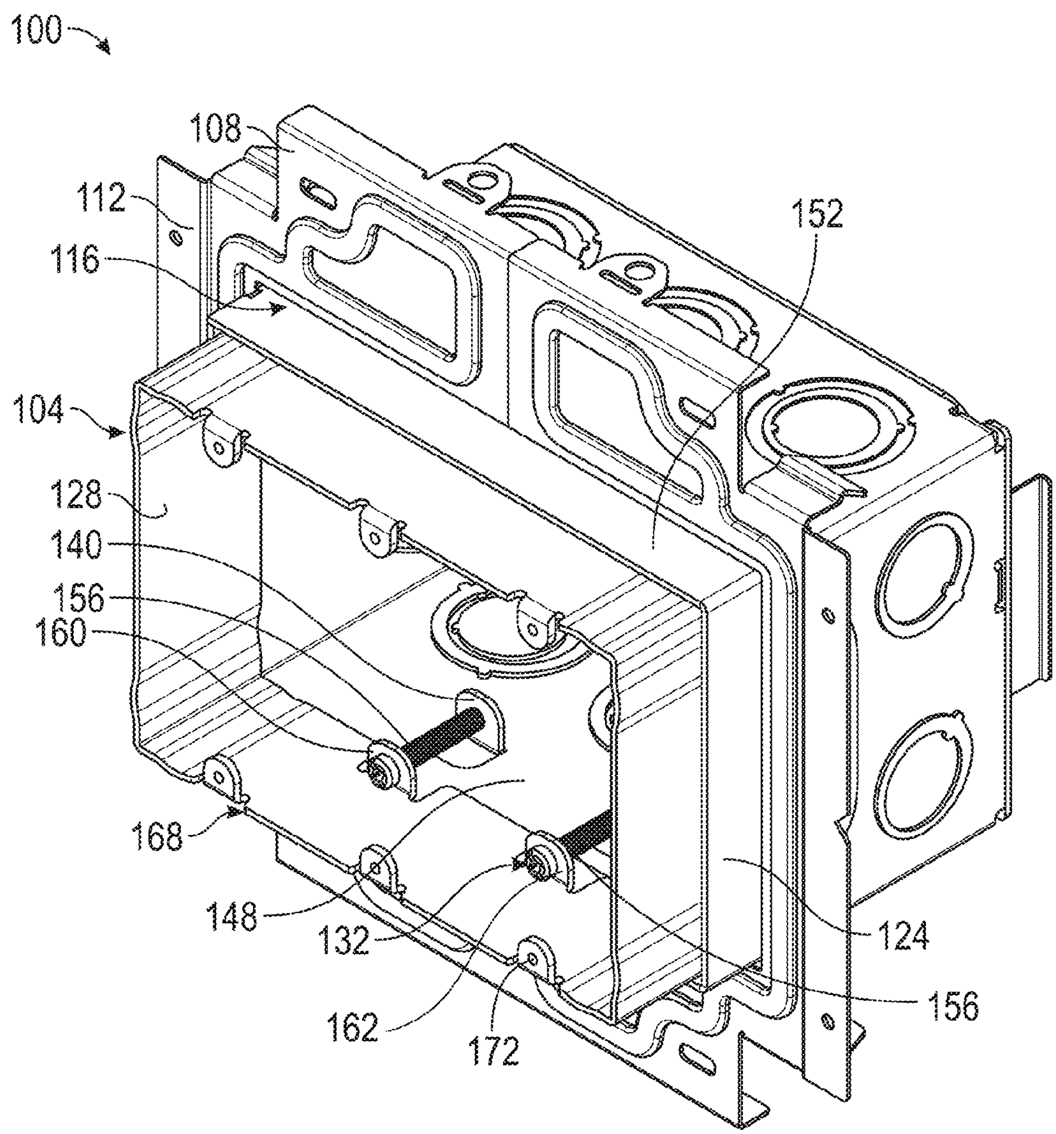
(57) **ABSTRACT**

An assembly for an adjustable-depth electrical box can include a housing with outer sidewalls that slidably receive an extendable sleeve. A first housing tab may extend integrally from a first outer sidewall. A first hole may be disposed in the first outer sidewall, adjacent the first housing tab, and a first cover may close the first hole. An extendable sleeve including sleeve walls and a first sleeve tab may be provided. The outer sidewalls may slidably receive an extendable sleeve. An adjustment fastener may extend through the first housing tab and may be rotatable to adjust a depth of the extendable sleeve relative to the housing.



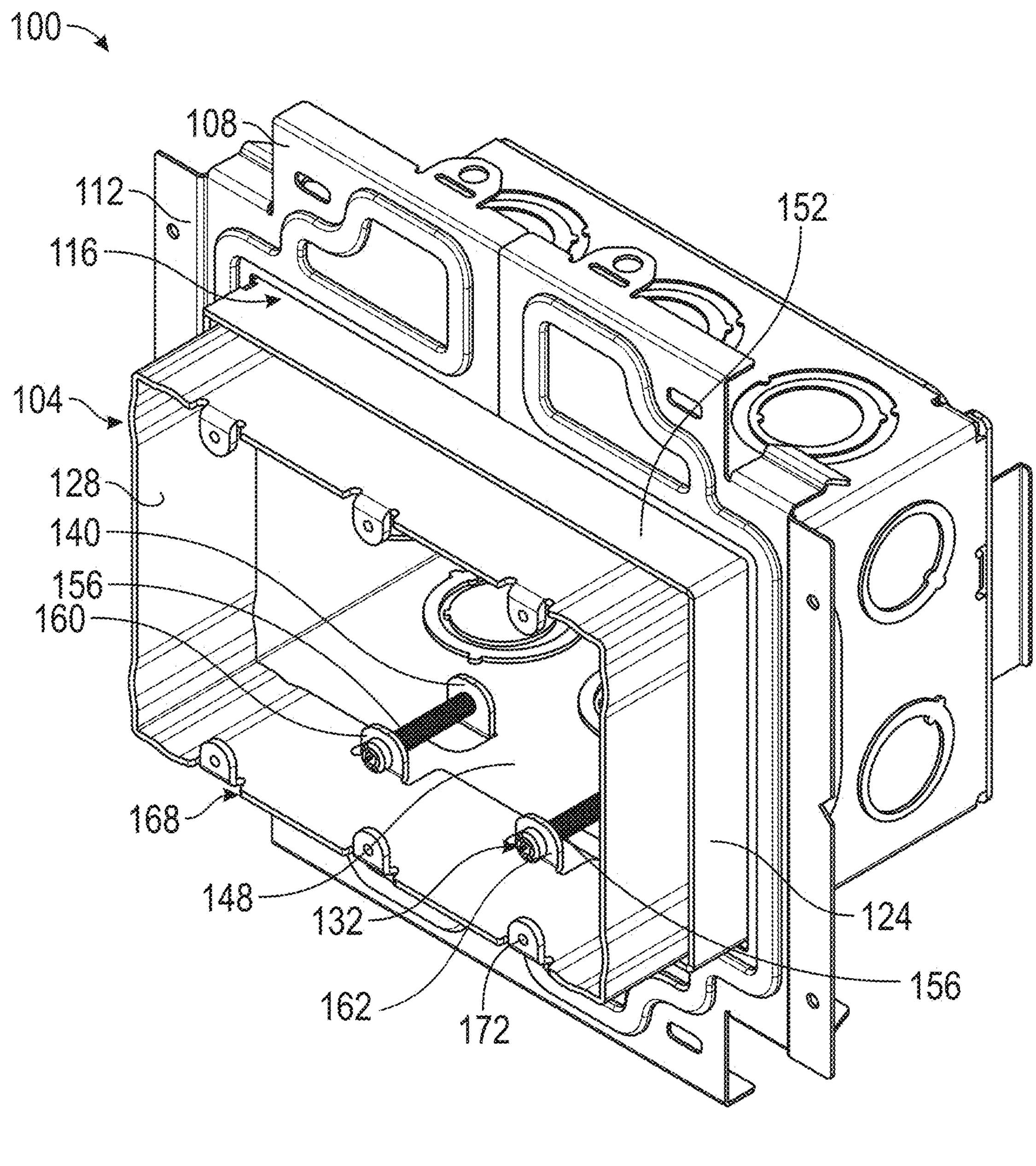

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FIG. 1

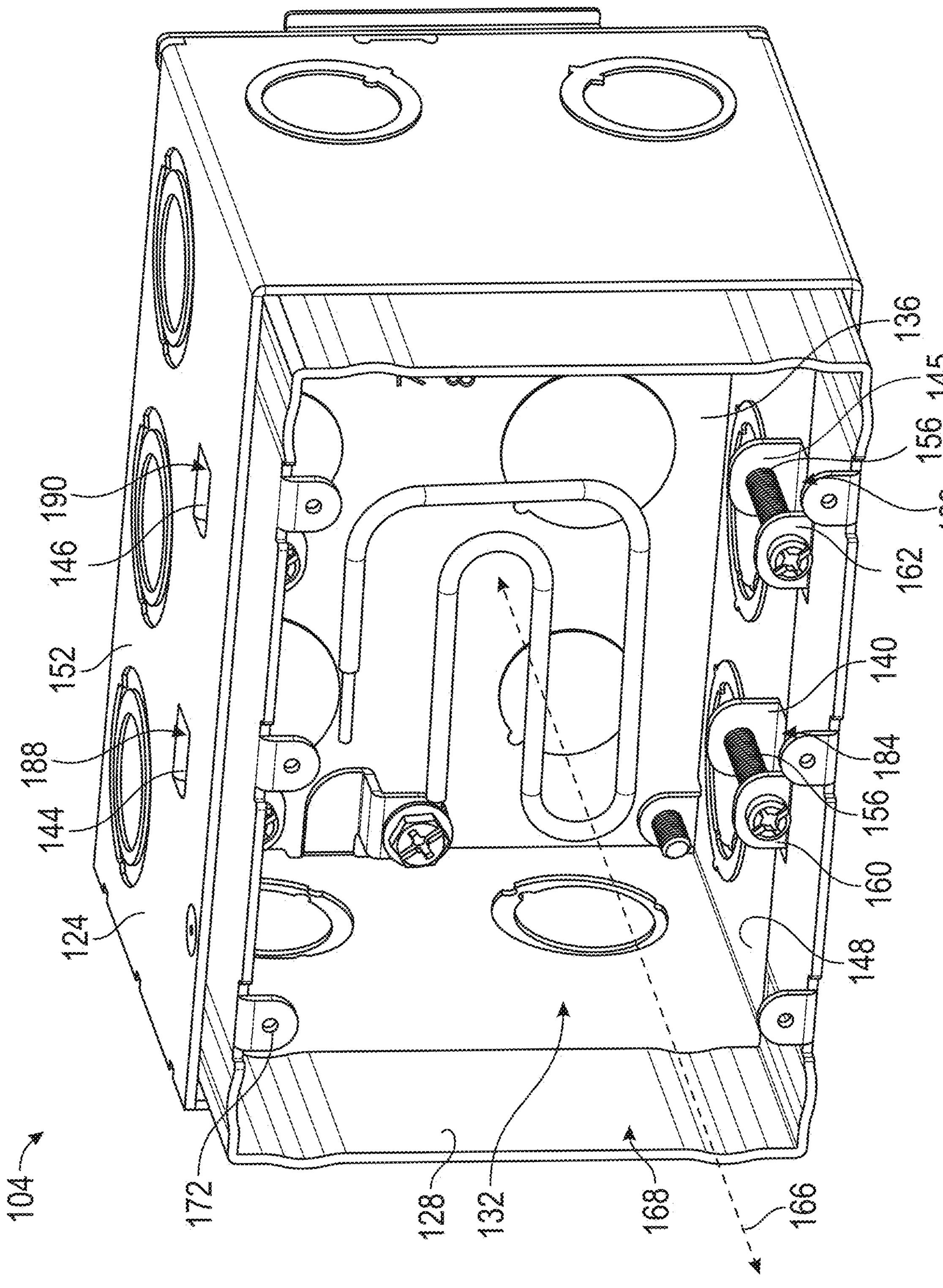
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FIG. 2

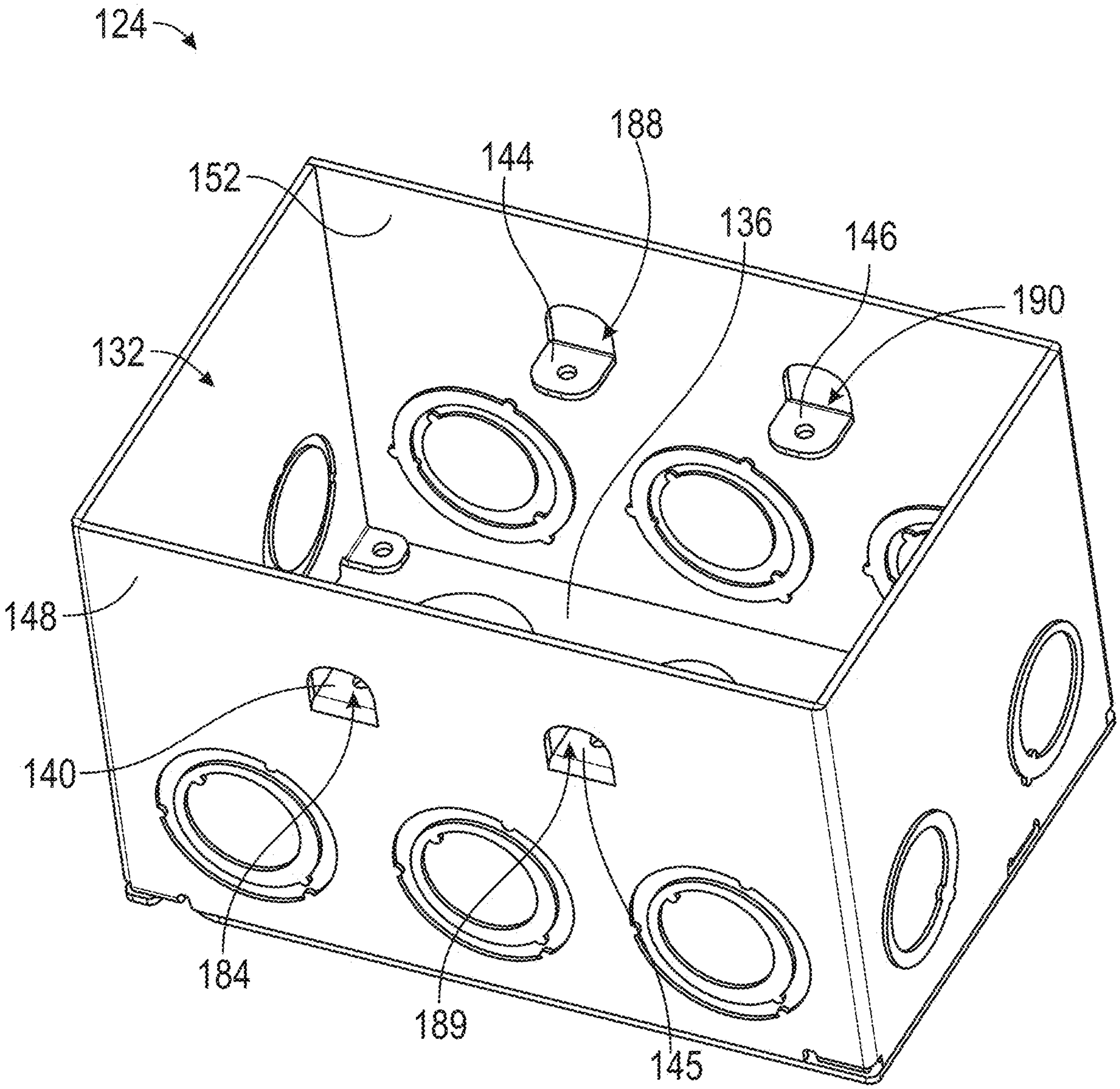

FIG. 3

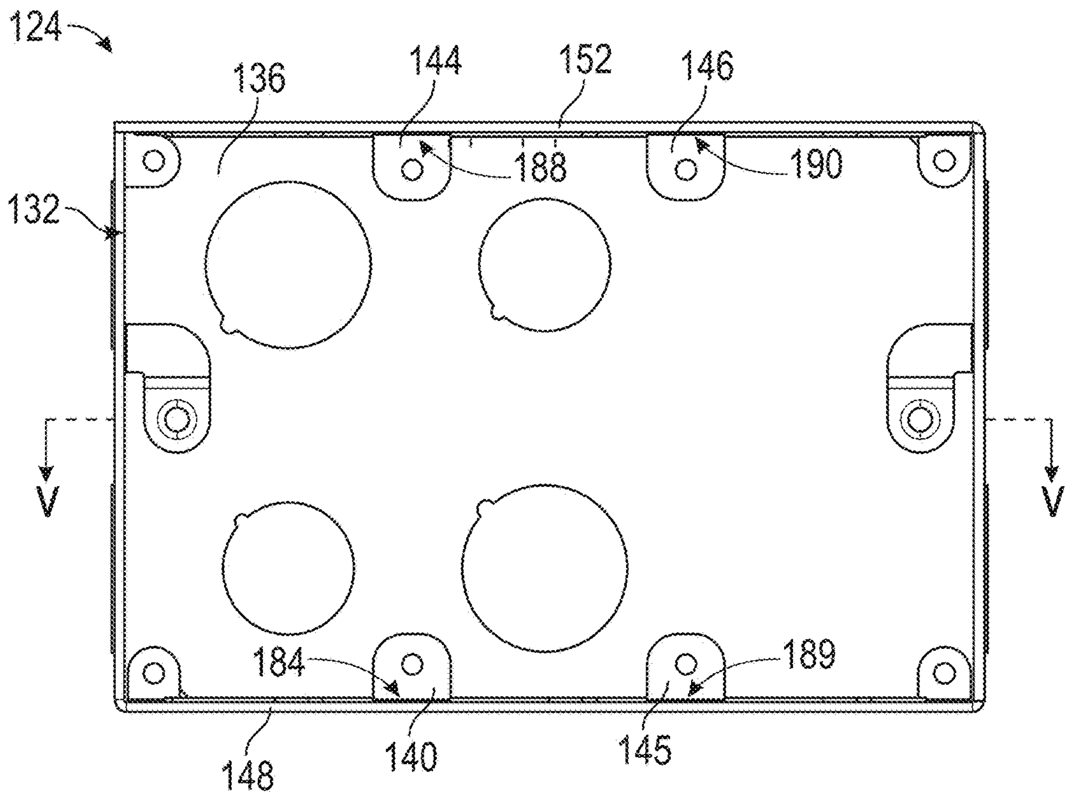
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FIG. 4

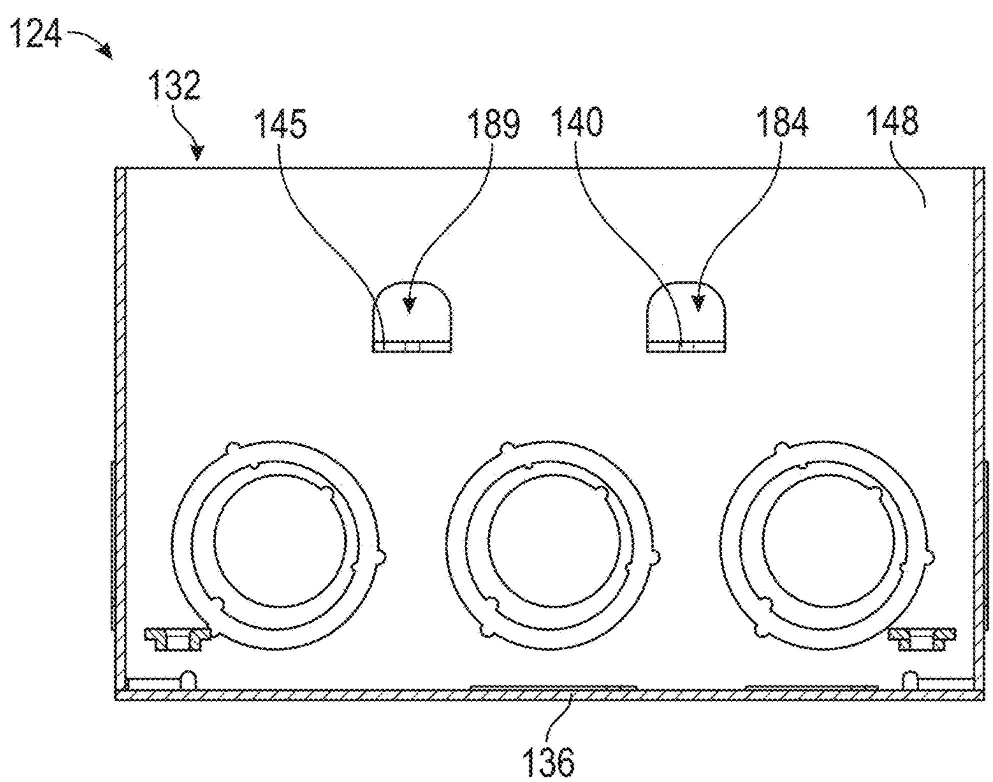
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FIG. 5

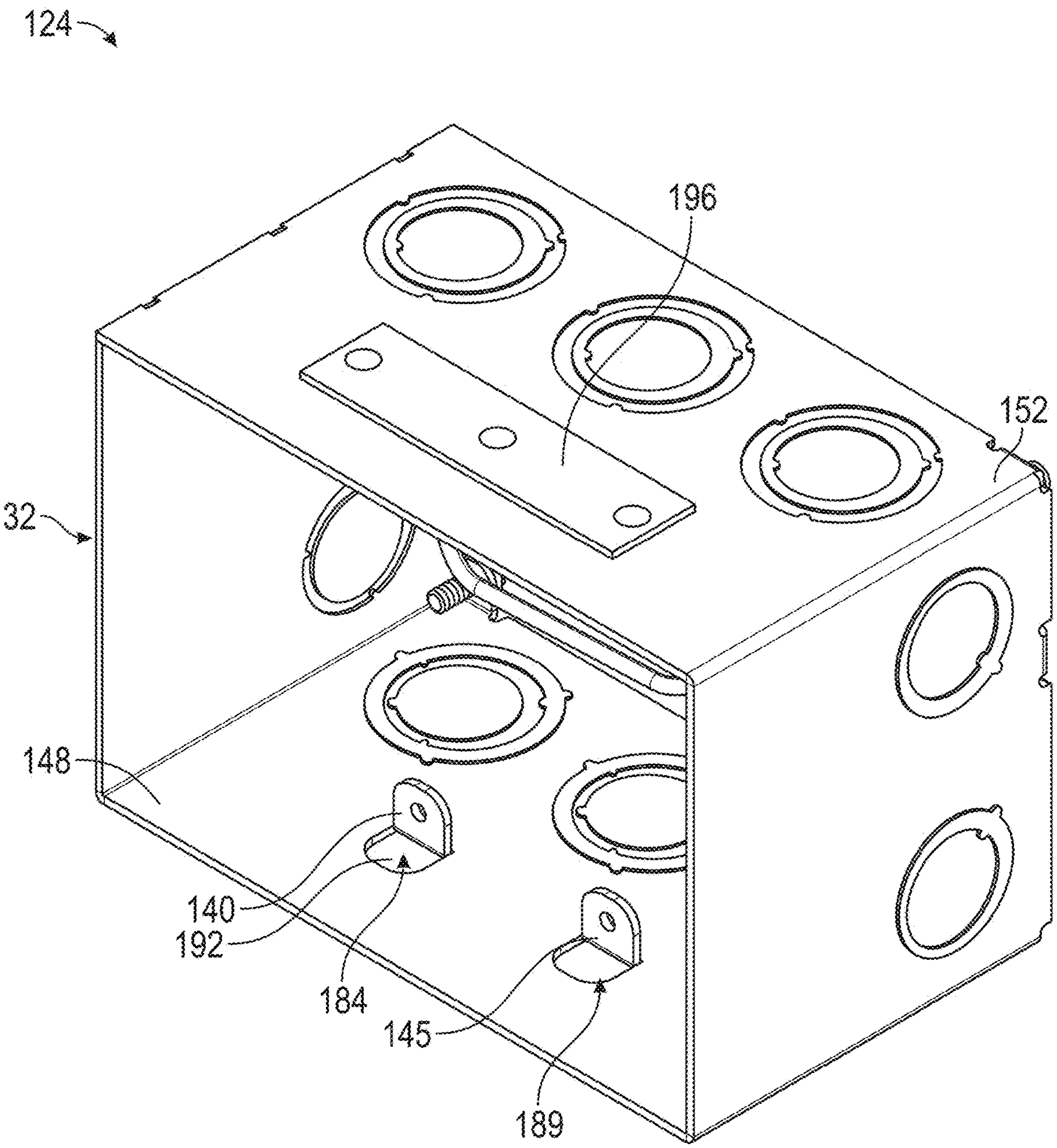
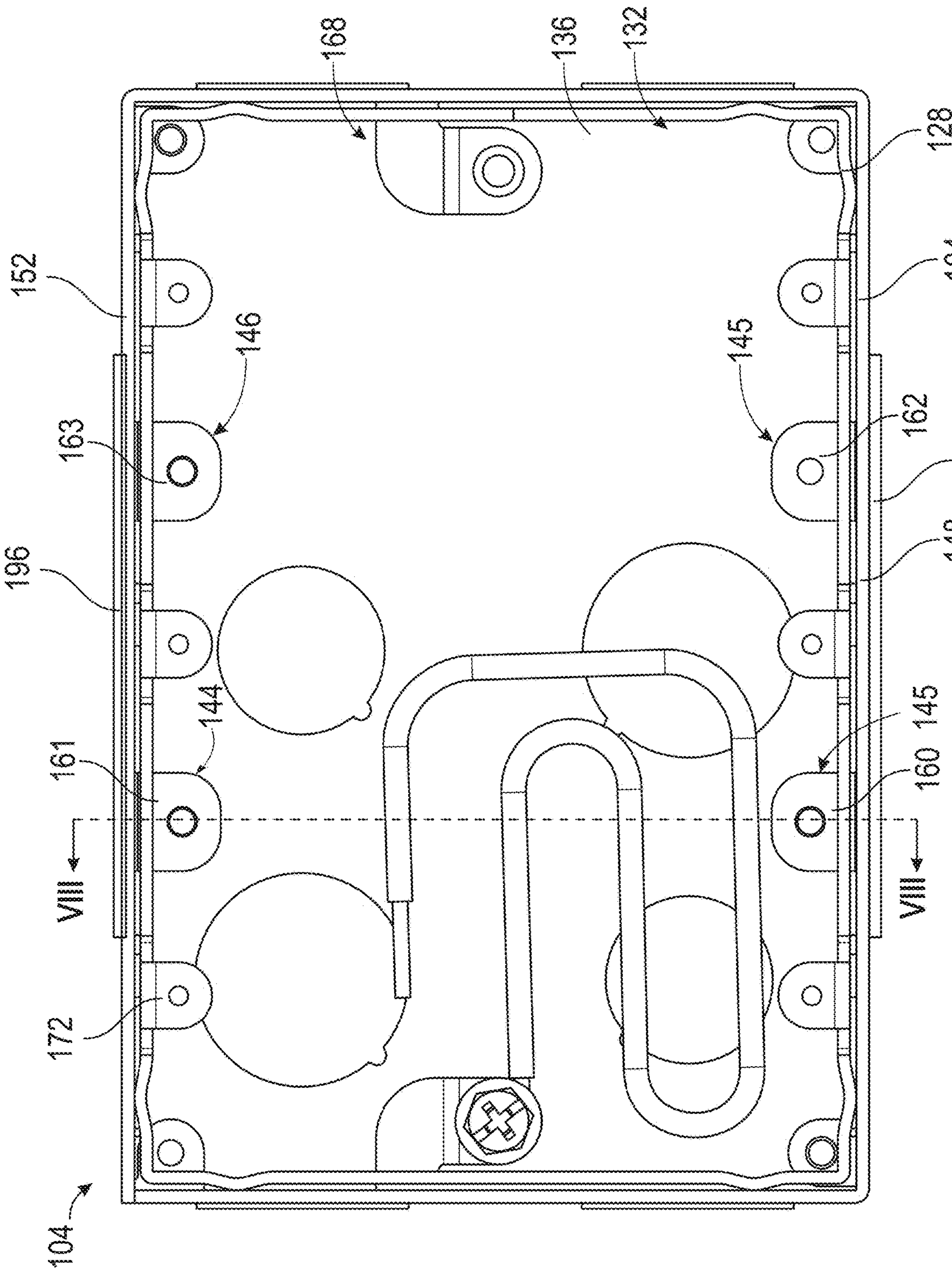


FIG. 6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VIII
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FIG. 7

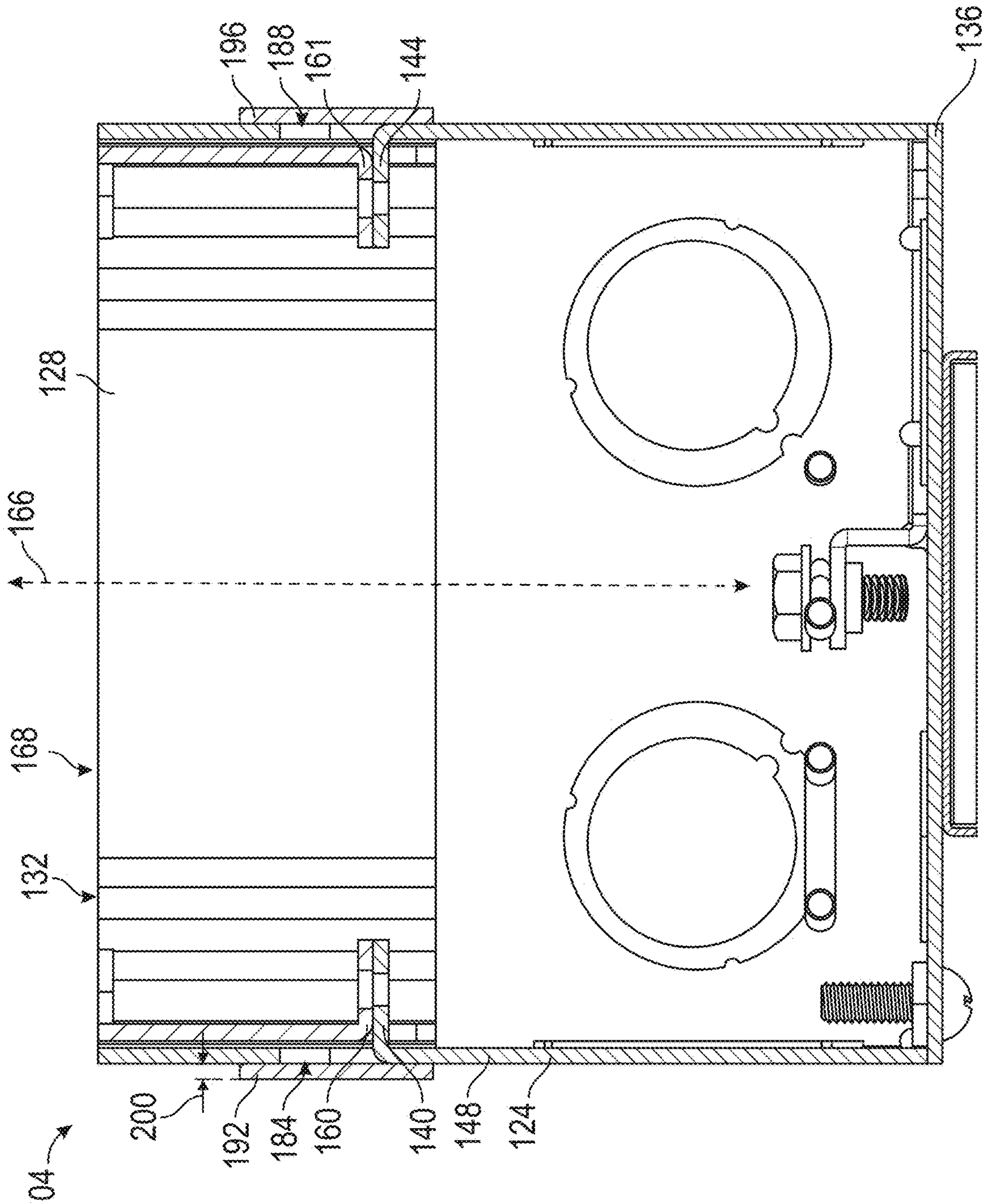
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FIG. 8

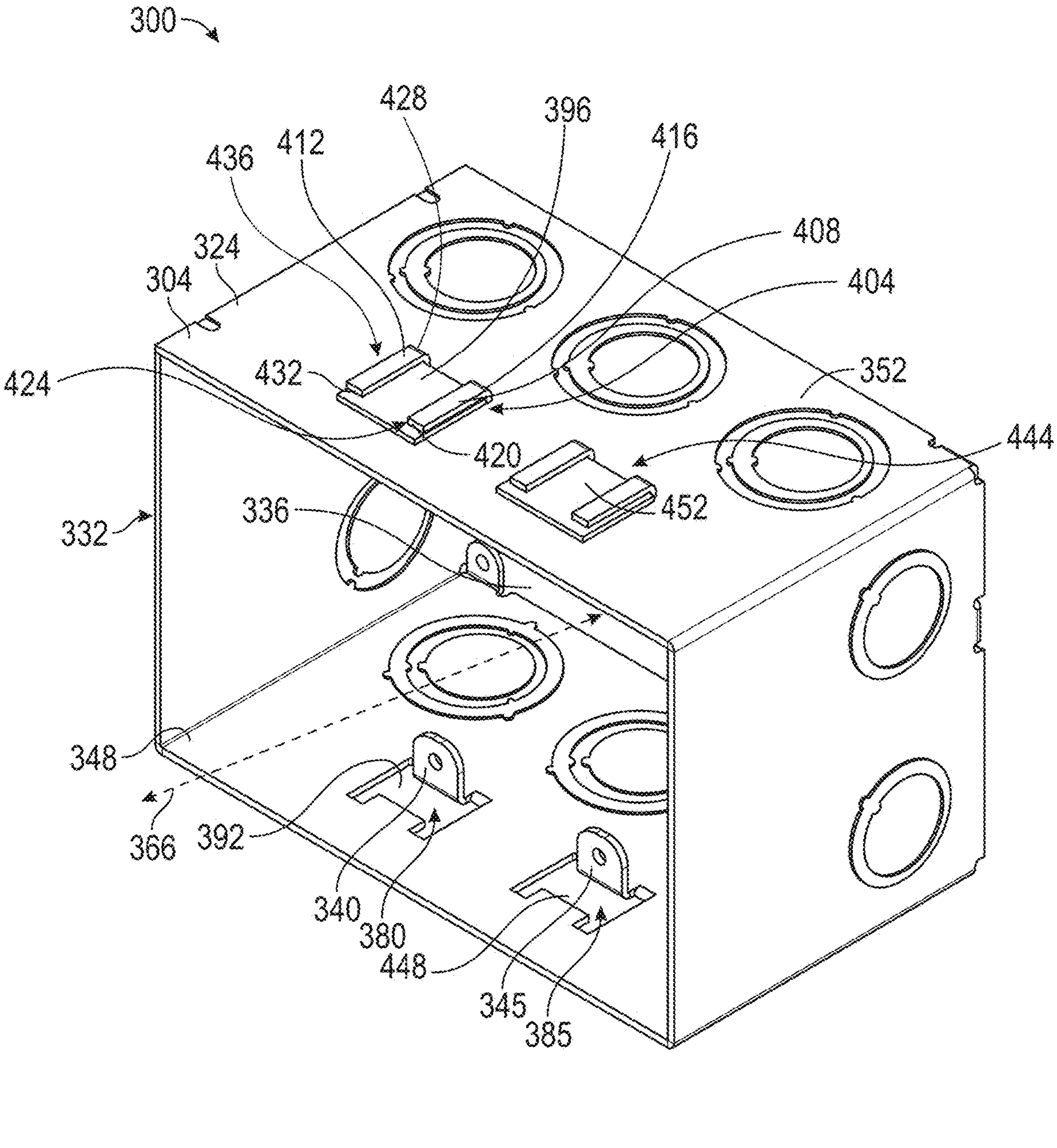
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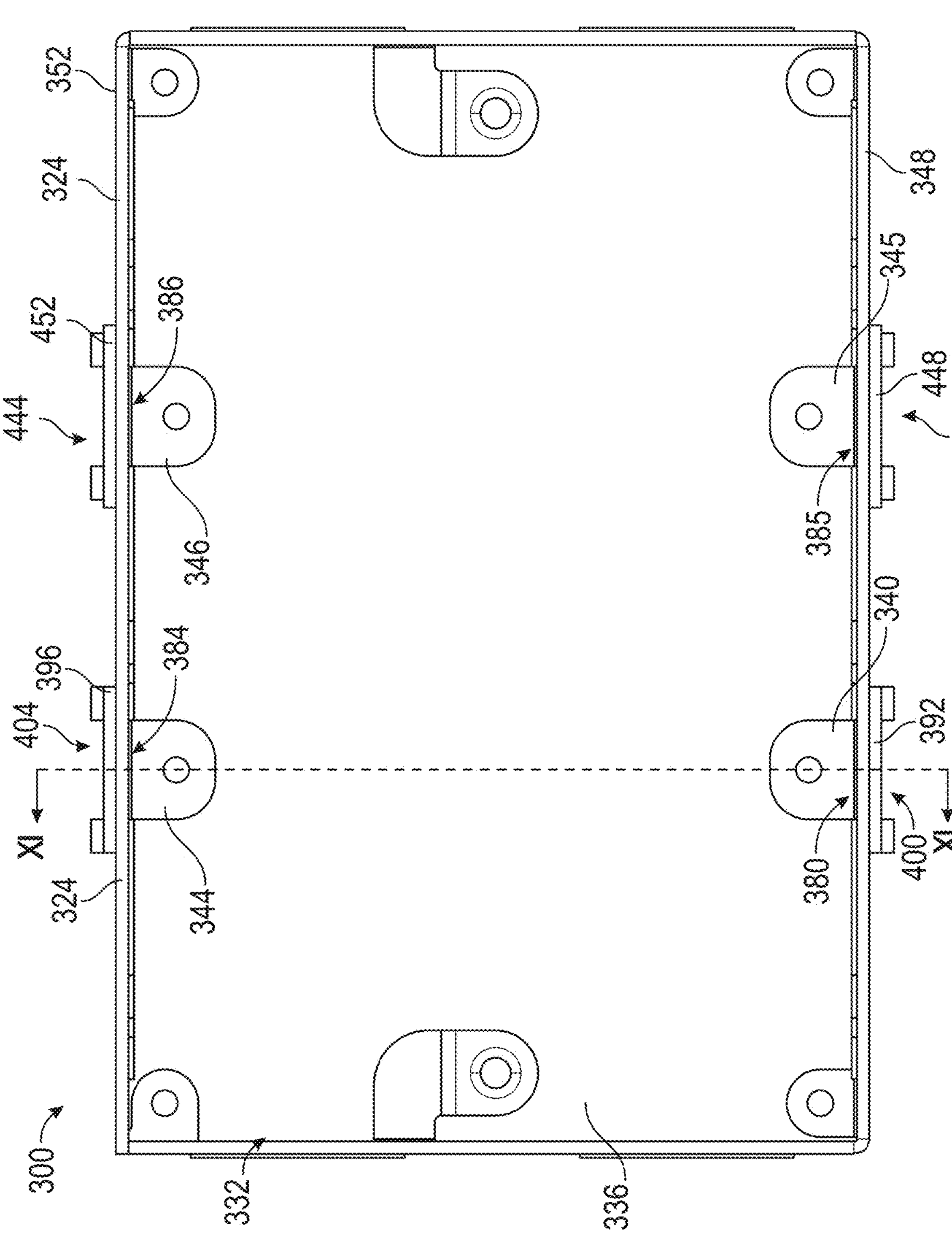
FIG. 9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XI

FIG. 10

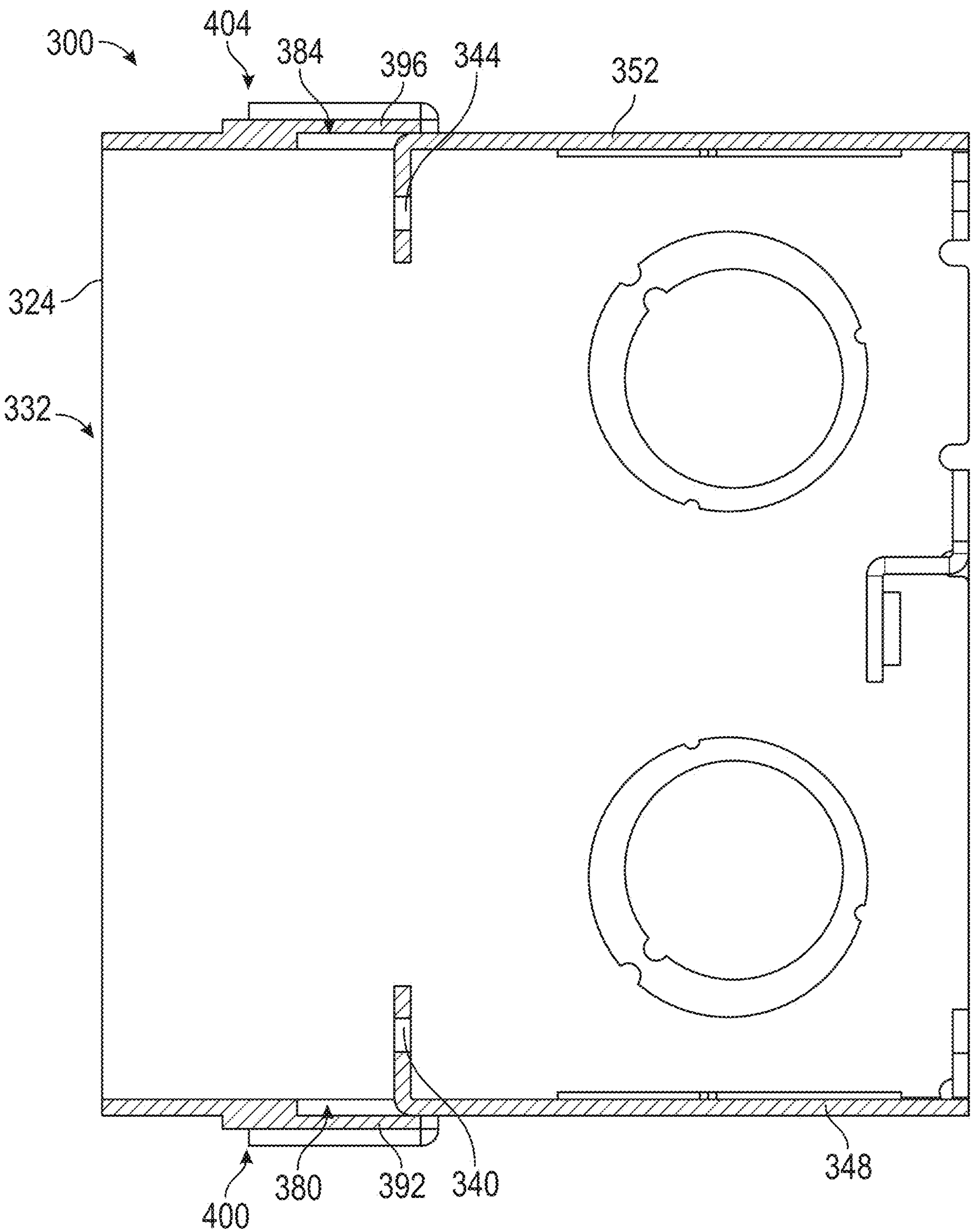

FIG. 11

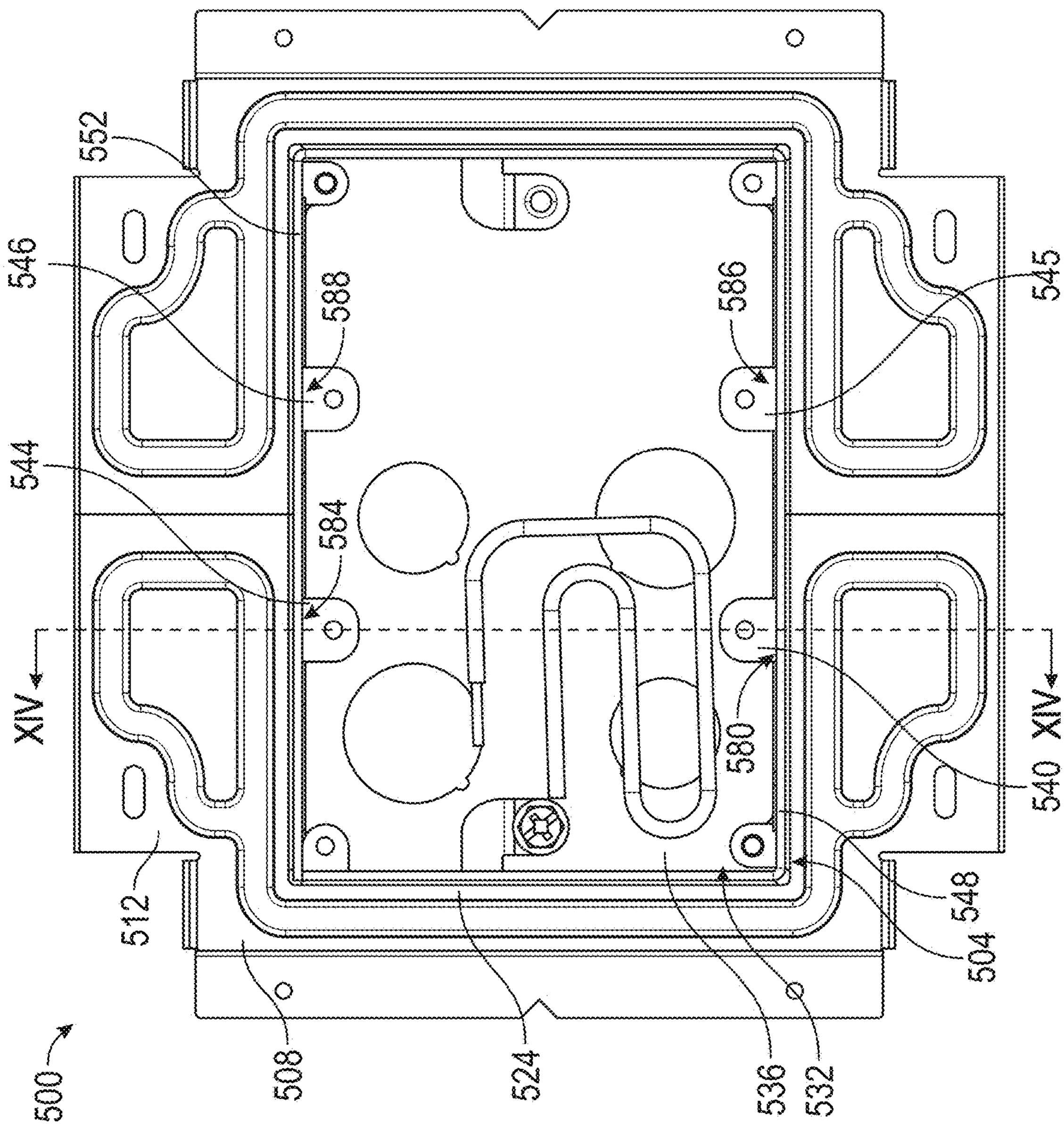
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FIG. 12

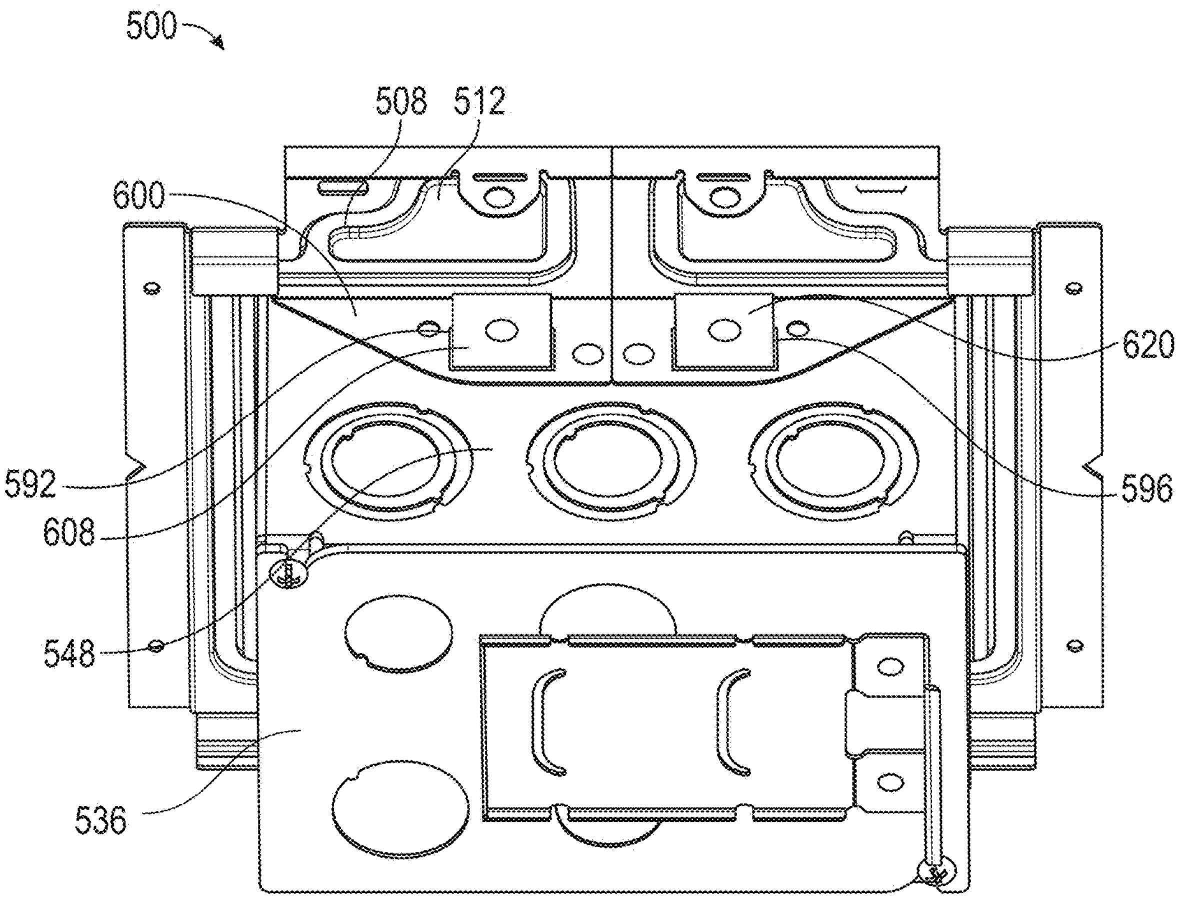

FIG. 13

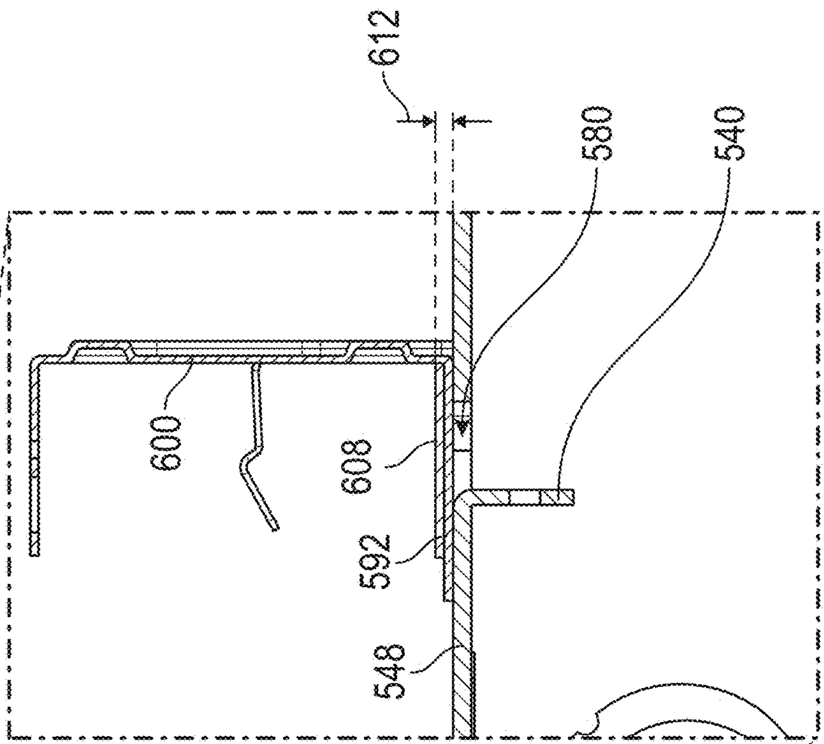

FIG. 14B

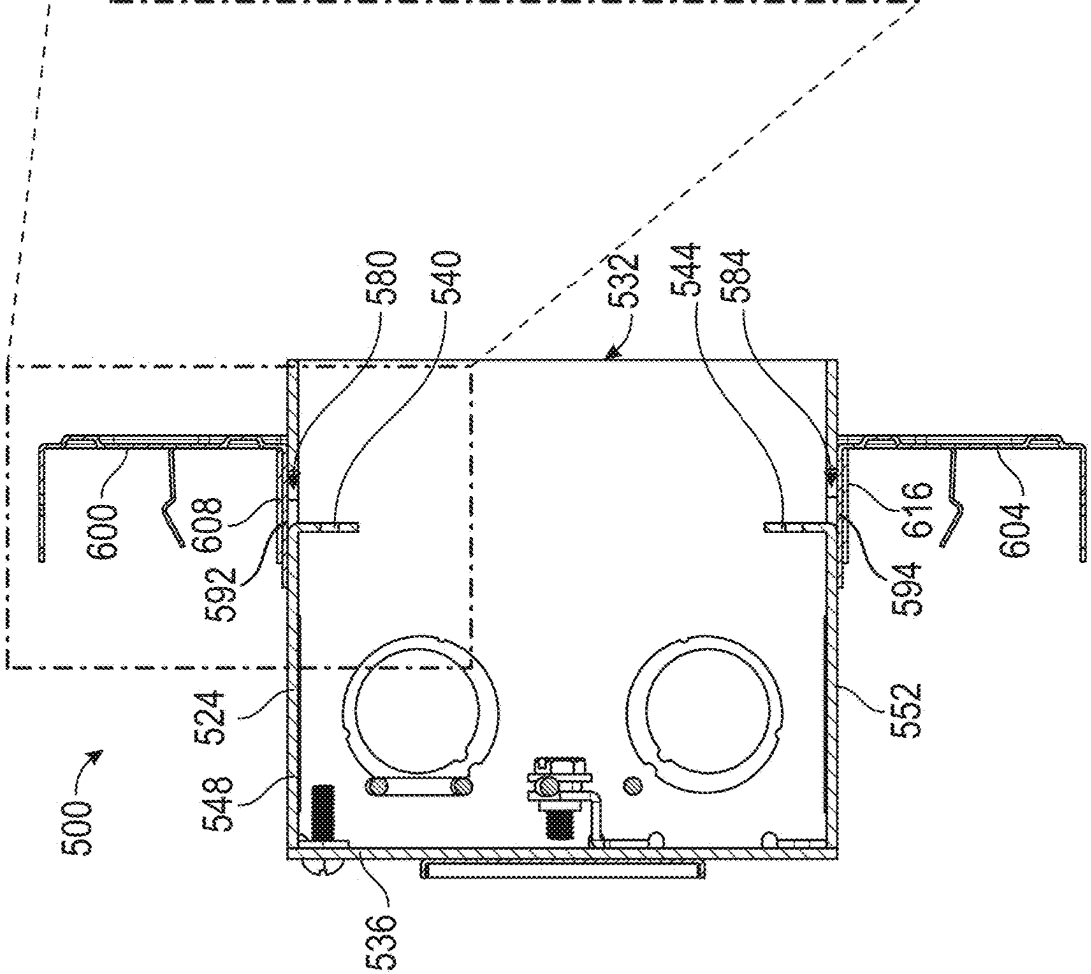

FIG. 14A

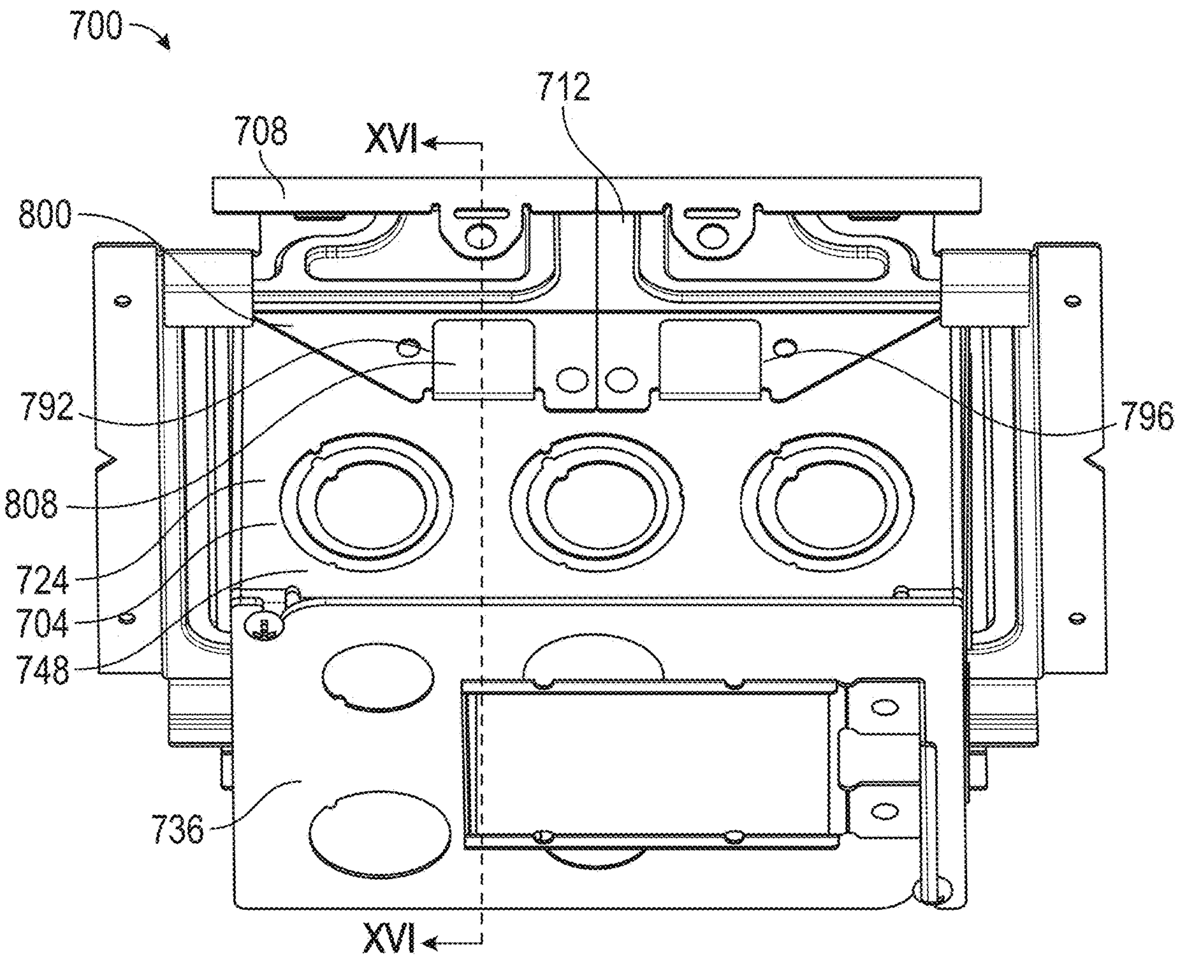

FIG. 15A

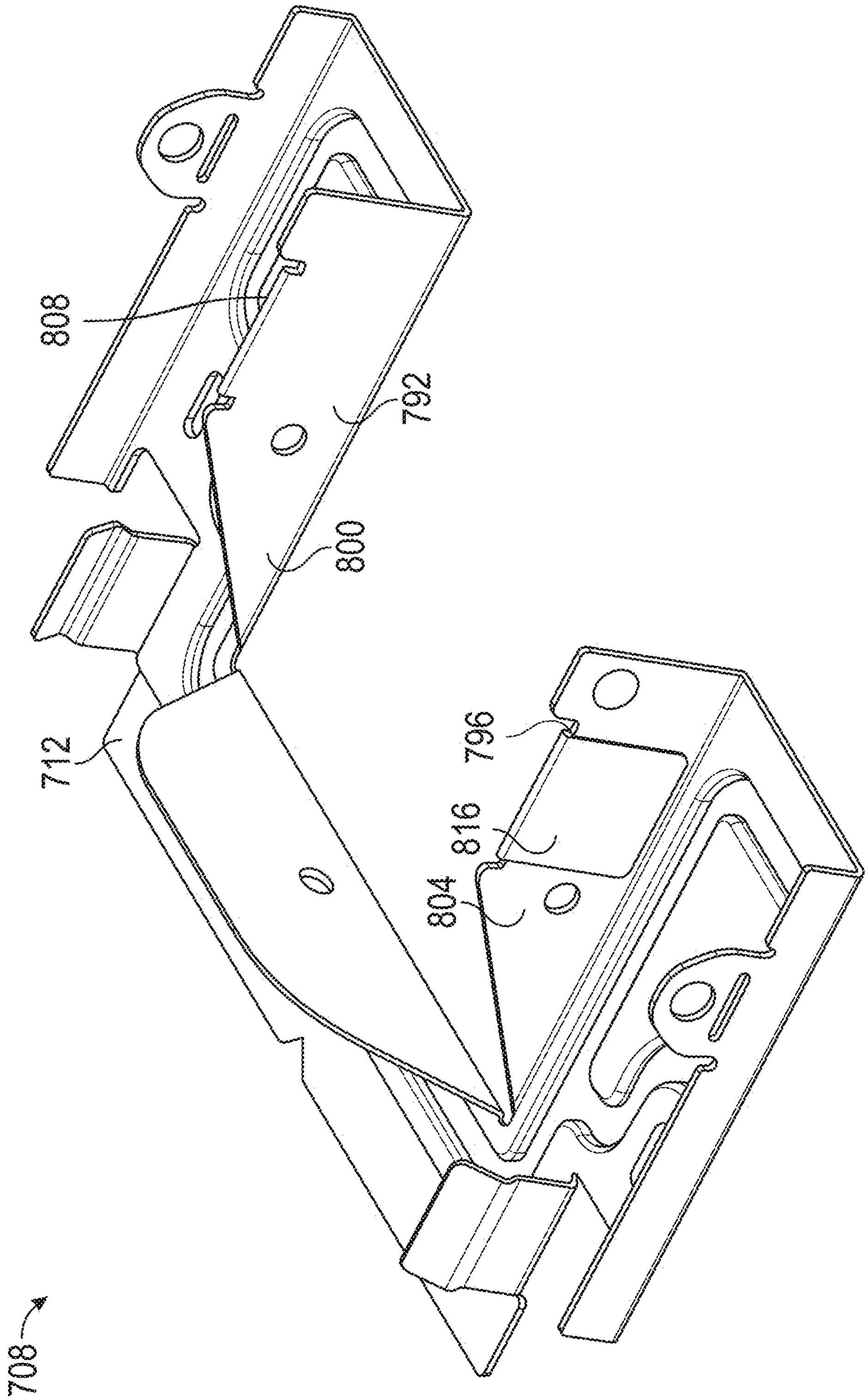

FIG. 15B

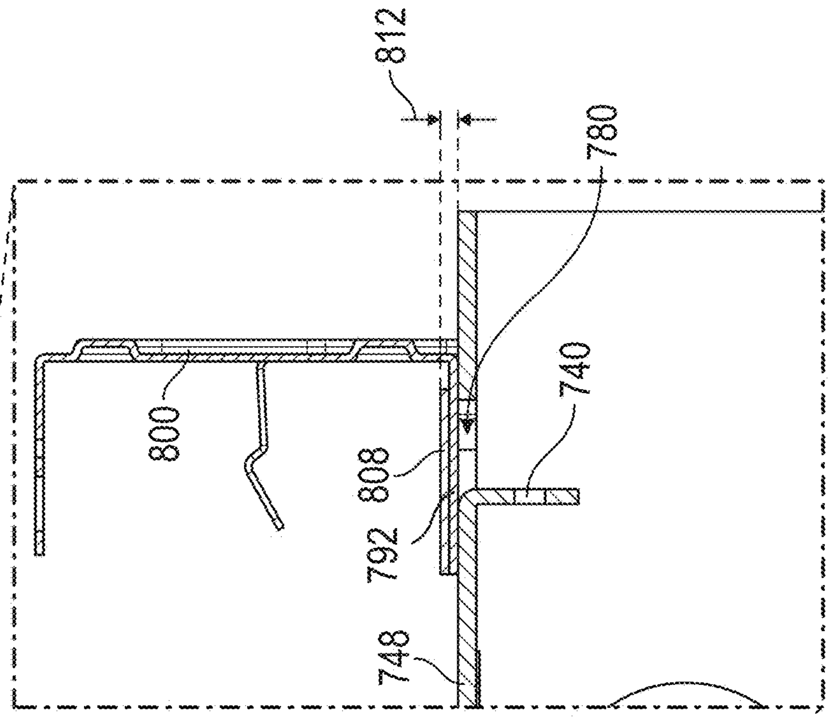

FIG. 16B

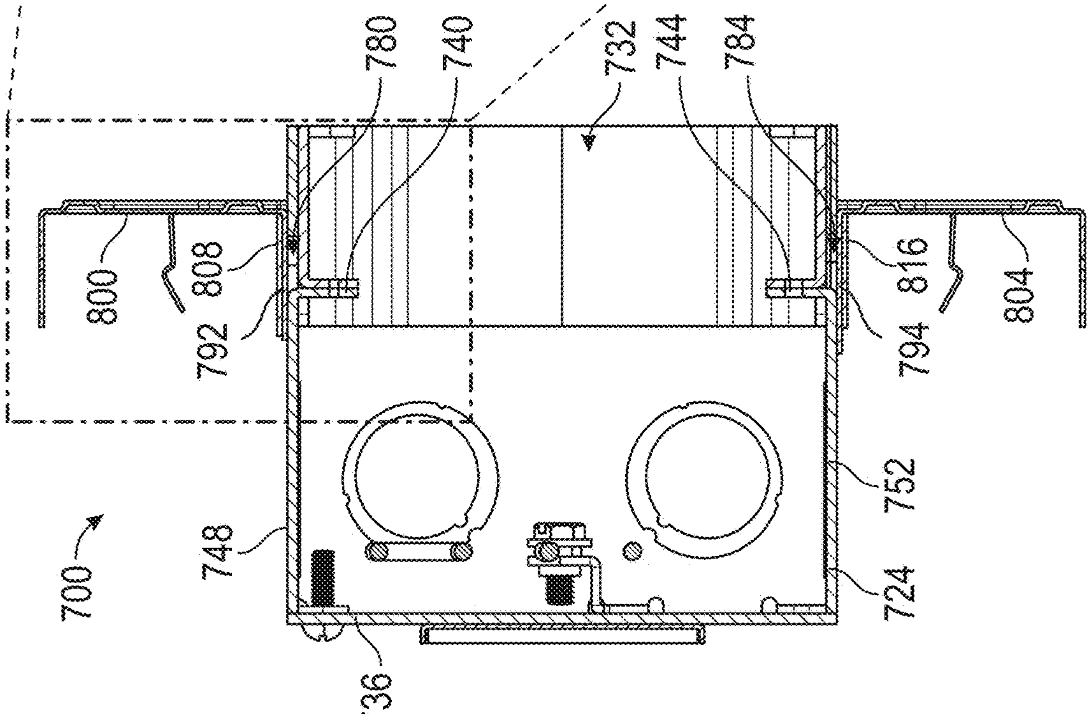

FIG. 16A

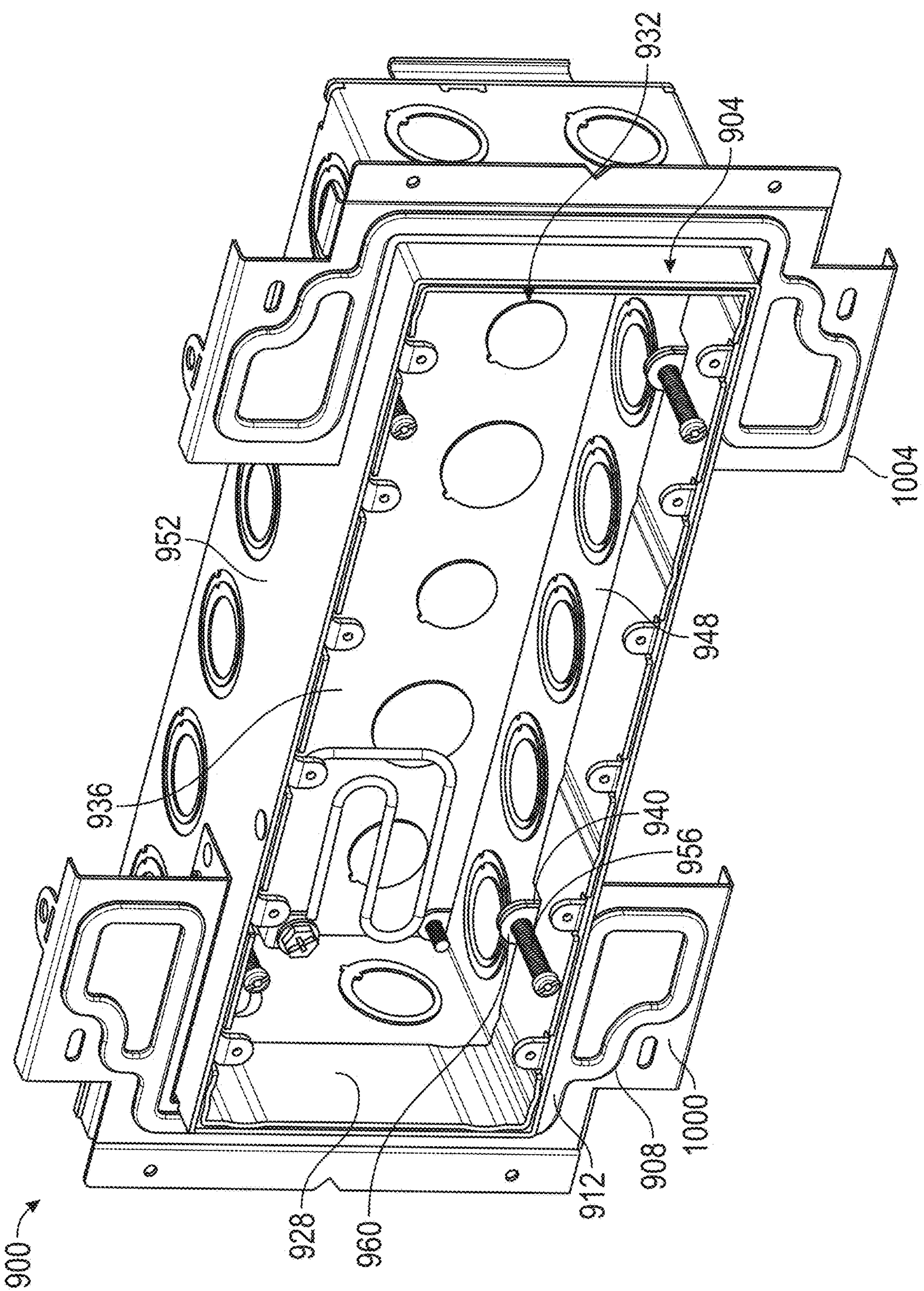

FIG. 17A

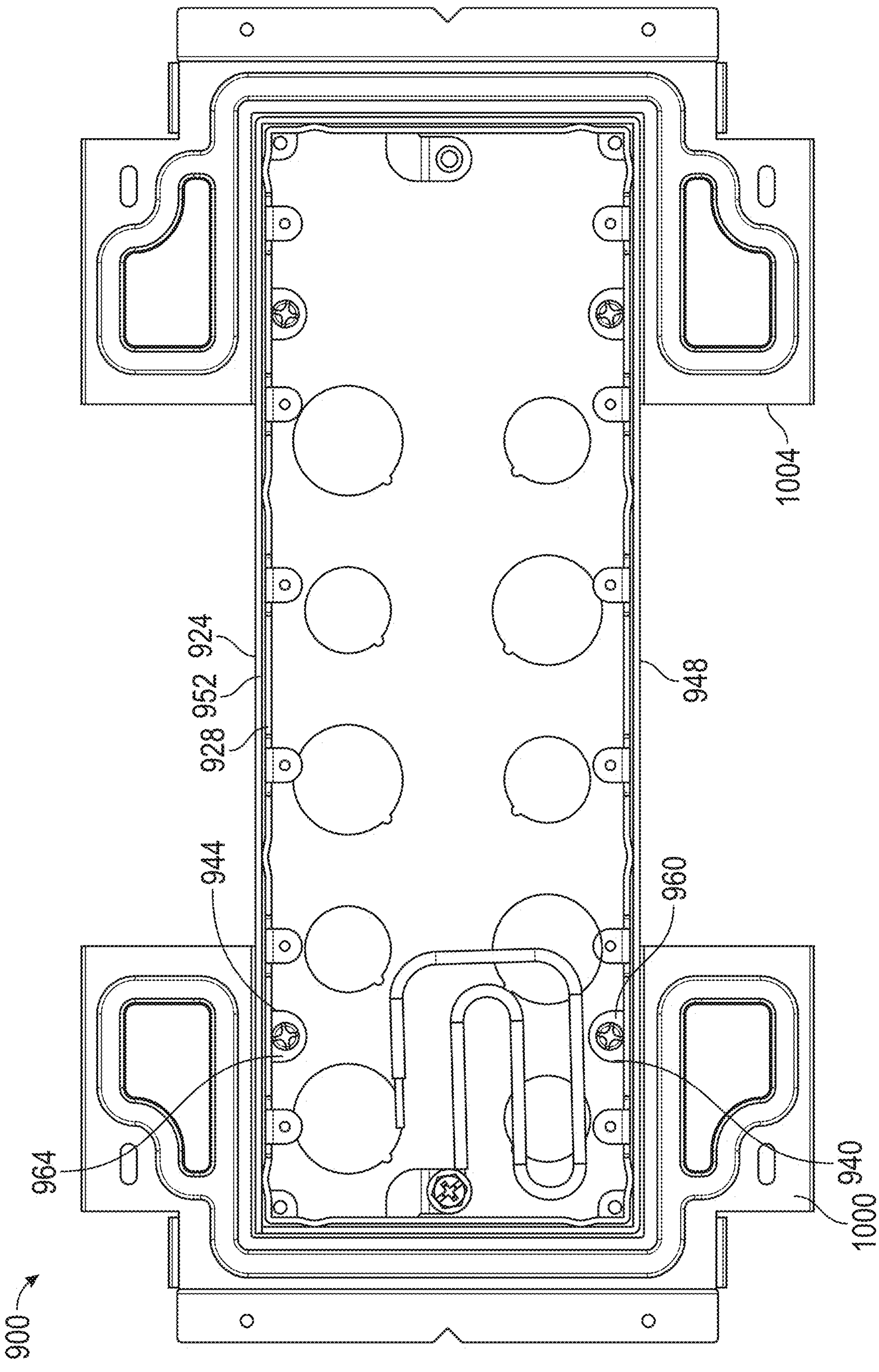

FIG. 17B

ADJUSTABLE ELECTRICAL BOX

CROSS-SECTION TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] This application claims priority to and incorporates by reference U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/558,734, filed Feb. 28, 2024.

BACKGROUND

[0002] In many applications, it may be useful to support electrical boxes at different depths relative to support structures, including ceiling or wall structures of buildings.

SUMMARY

[0003] Some embodiments of the invention provide an adjustable-depth electrical box assembly. The assembly may include an adjustable-depth electrical box that can include a housing. The housing may include outer sidewalls extending from a base end to an open end of the housing, including a first outer sidewall. A first housing tab may extend integrally from the first outer sidewall, with a first hole disposed in the first outer sidewall, adjacent the first housing tab. The assembly may further include an extendable sleeve with sleeve walls and a first sleeve tab, where the outer sidewalls can slidably receive the extendable sleeve. A first cover may contact an exterior of the first outer sidewall, closing the first hole. An adjustment fastener may extend through the first housing tab and the first sleeve tab and may be rotatable to adjust a depth of the extendable sleeve relative to the housing.

[0004] Some embodiments of the invention provide an adjustable-depth electrical box assembly. The assembly may include an adjustable-depth electrical box that can include a housing. The housing may include outer sidewalls extending from a base end to an open end of the housing, including a first outer sidewall. A first housing tab may be stamped from the first outer sidewall. A first hole may be resultant from the stamping of the first housing tab. A first cover plate may contact the first outer sidewall, closing the first hole. The assembly may further include an extendable sleeve and a fastener extending through the first housing tab to adjust the extendable sleeve relative to the housing.

[0005] Some embodiments of the invention provide a method of assembling an adjustable-depth electrical box. In some embodiments, the method may include forming a housing with a housing tab integrally formed with a sidewall of the housing. The method may include closing a hole disposed adjacent the housing tab with a cover contacting the housing. The method may include aligning an extendable sleeve to be inserted into the housing so that the housing tab is aligned with a sleeve tab of the extendable sleeve. The method may include installing an adjustment fastener to extend through the housing tab and the sleeve tab to adjust the extendable sleeve relative to the housing.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0006] The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated in and form a part of this specification, illustrate embodiments of the invention and, together with the description, serve to explain the principles of embodiments of the invention:

[0007] FIG. **1** is an axonometric view of an electrical box assembly, with an adjustable-depth electrical box in a partially extended position according to an embodiment of the invention;

[0008] FIG. **2** is an axonometric view of an embodiment of a housing and an extendable sleeve of the electrical box assembly of FIG. **1**;

[0009] FIG. **3** is an axonometric view of the housing of the electrical box assembly of FIG. **2**;

[0010] FIG. **4** is a front elevation view of the housing of the electrical box assembly of FIG. **2**;

[0011] FIG. **5** is a cross-sectional view of the electrical box assembly of FIG. **4**, taken at V-V;

[0012] FIG. **6** is an axonometric view of an embodiment of a housing of the electrical box assembly of FIG. **1**, including a first example of a cover plate;

[0013] FIG. **7** is a front elevation view of an electrical box FIG. **6**, including the cover plate;

[0014] FIG. **8** is a cross-sectional view of the electrical box of FIG. **7**, taken at VIII-VIII;

[0015] FIG. **9** is an axonometric view of an embodiment of a housing of the electrical box assembly of FIG. **1**, including a second example of the cover plate;

[0016] FIG. **10** is a front elevation view of the housing of FIG. **9**;

[0017] FIG. **11** is a cross-sectional view of the housing of FIG. **10**, taken at XI-XI;

[0018] FIG. **12** is a front elevation view of an embodiment of the electrical box assembly of FIG. **1**, including a housing and a centerplate;

[0019] FIG. **13** is an axonometric view of the housing and centerplate of FIG. **12**;

[0020] FIG. **14**A is a cross-sectional view of the housing and centerplate of FIG. **12**, taken at XIV-XIV;

[0021] FIG. **14**B is a partial detail view of FIG. **14**A;

[0022] FIG. **15**A is an axonometric view of an embodiment of a housing and centerplate of the electrical box assembly of FIG. **1**;

[0023] FIG. **15**B an axonometric view of a portion of the centerplate of the electrical box assembly of FIG. **1**

[0024] FIG. **16**A is a cross-sectional view of the housing and centerplate of FIG. **15**, taken at XVI-XVI;

[0025] FIG. **16**B is a partial detail view of FIG. **16**A;

[0026] FIG. **17**A is an axonometric view of an electrical box assembly according to an embodiment of the invention; and

[0027] FIG. **17**B is a front elevation view of the electrical box assembly of FIG. **17**A.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0028] Before any embodiments of the invention are explained in detail, it is to be understood that the invention is not limited in its application to the details of construction and the arrangement of components set forth in the following description or illustrated in the following drawings. The invention is capable of other embodiments and of being practiced or of being carried out in various ways.

[0029] The following discussion is presented to enable a person skilled in the art to make and use embodiments of the invention. Various modifications to the illustrated embodiments will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art, and the generic principles herein can be applied to other embodiments and applications without departing from embodiments of the invention. Thus, embodiments of the invention are not intended to be limited to embodiments shown, but are to be accorded the widest scope consistent with the principles and features disclosed herein. The following detailed description is to be read with reference to the figures, in which like elements in different figures have like reference numerals. The figures, which are not necessarily to scale, depict selected embodiments and are not intended to limit the scope of embodiments of the invention. Skilled artisans will recognize the examples provided herein have many useful alternatives and fall within the scope of embodiments of the invention.

[0030] As noted above, in some contexts, it may be useful to support electrical boxes at different depths relative to relevant building structures. In this regard, an electrical box having an adjustable extension may provide flexibility for installers. For example, in some installations an electrical box assembly may need to be arranged with a front opening of an electrical box flush with an exterior surface of a wall or ceiling structure (e.g., drywall, tile, etc.). However, other portions of an electrical box assembly may need to be engaged with a building support structure (e.g., a stud, support bracket, ceiling structure, etc.) at a depth that can vary between different sites or installations. Further in this regard, it can sometimes be difficult to precisely space a support structure relative to the relevant surfaces of drywall or ceiling tile. For example, the relevant support structure may be offset from the interior surface of the drywall or ceiling at an undesirable distance (e.g., too far away) relative to a depth of a fixed-depth electrical box. It may accordingly be beneficial to install an adjustable electrical box having an adjustably extendable component, so as to be able to selectively extend or retract the extendable component of the electrical box to comply with relevant spacing (or other) requirements.

[0031] Correspondingly, embodiments of the invention can provide an electrical box and associated assembly or method that can allow easy adjustment of an extension of an electrical box relative to a support structure, including after the electrical box has been installed on the support structure. Examples of the present invention may accordingly save time and money during installation and provide for improved service configurations, including by allowing installers to simply adjust the extension of the electrical box itself to accommodate the needs of a particular installation. Some examples can be used with assemblies having far side supports (e.g., with masonry-box or other assemblies configured to be secured directly to a stud). Some examples can be used with assemblies having no far side supports (e.g., with light-fixture or other assemblies configured to be secured with a between-stud bracket).

[0032] Generally, embodiments of the invention can include an electrical box assembly configured to support electrical components (e.g., low voltage devices or other known electrical devices, etc.). The electrical box assembly may be secured to one or more other structures directly or indirectly, including in various in-wall and overhead applications (e.g., with direct mounting to studs or ceiling, or with indirect mounting via brackets supports on studs or T-grid ceiling members). The electrical box assembly may be adjusted to a desired alignment, including to be flush with a visible surface in a building (e.g., wall or ceiling surfaces of various types, including drywall and ceiling tiles, etc.). Thus, some examples can be flexibly used with support structures that have a wide range of distances from a relevant surface (e.g., of exposed drywall).

[0033] The electrical box assembly may include an electrical box with a housing and an extendable sleeve nested within the housing. The extendable sleeve may be configured to be translationally adjusted relative to the housing along an axis that is transverse to the base of the housing. The extendable sleeve can be coupled to the electrical box housing with fasteners. Generally, in this regard, adjustment of the fasteners can adjust an extension of the extendable sleeve in an axial direction defined by the fasteners, relative to the electrical box housing.

[0034] In some embodiments, it may be useful to arrange the extendable sleeve and the housing so that the fasteners are disposed within an interior of the electrical box. For example, a set of housing tabs extending into the housing may receive and retain the fasteners. Conventionally, housing tabs can be affixed to the electrical box using a variety of coupling techniques (e.g., spot welding, a threaded fastener, or other related coupling technique). In such embodiments, it can be important to properly align the housing tabs with corresponding sleeve tabs disposed on the extendable sleeve, also configured to receive and retain the fasteners. However, present methods for securing the housing tabs to the housing can be inaccurate, leading to possible misalignment of the housing tabs of the housing and the sleeve tabs of the extendable sleeve. Such misalignment can potentially lead to damaged (e.g., stripped) adjustment fasteners, improper extension of the electrical box, and other issues.

[0035] In some embodiments, in order to rectify issues regarding misalignment of the housing tabs and the sleeve tabs, the housing tabs may be formed integrally with the sidewall(s) of the housing. For example, the housing tab(s) can be stamped or otherwise cut from the sidewall(s) of the housing, and bent to an operational orientation. Utilizing a process such as stamping to form the housing tabs with the sidewalls of the housing can increase positional precision and accuracy, leading to less issues regarding misalignment of the housing and sleeve tabs (e.g., as compared to welding).

[0036] During the process of integrally forming the housing tabs from the sidewalls of the housing, one or more holes may be created in the sidewalls. In some embodiments, it may be advantageous to close or cover the holes using a cover plate. As will be described below, the hole(s) can be closed using cover(s) (e.g., cover plates) secured directly to the electrical box, or by cover(s) secured to a centerplate of the electrical box assembly. Furthermore, in some embodiments, it may be advantageous to position the cover on an exterior surface of the housing. As will be described below, positioning the cover on an exterior surface of the housing may advantageously reduce the chance of the cover obstructing components within the housing. Additionally, positioning the cover on an exterior surface of the housing may advantageously allow the cover to be easily installed and to more easily cover an entire hole resultant from the stamping of the housing tab.

[0037] Referring to FIG. **1**, an example electrical box assembly **100** is shown according to an embodiment of the invention. In the illustrated example, the electrical box assembly **100** includes an electrical box **104** (shown here as a rectangular electrical box) and a centerplate **108**. The centerplate **108** has a plate body **112** with a plate opening **116** configured to receive the electrical box **104** therein and therethrough. As shown in FIG. **1**, the plate opening **116** is sized and configured to closely follow the rectangle shape of the electrical box **104**. This can provide for stable support of the electrical box and reliable installation. In other embodiments, however, other mounting brackets (e.g., other centerplates) may be used, including other on- or between-stud brackets variously known in the art. Further, some box assemblies may not include any similar bracket (e.g., may include only an adjustable-depth electrical box).

[0038] FIG. **1**. illustrates an example electrical box assembly **100** according to an embodiment of the invention. The electrical box assembly **100** may be secured to a support structure (e.g., a wall or ceiling structure), including using between-stud or other brackets of various known types (not shown). The electrical box assembly **100** may be used to secure one or more electrical components (e.g., light fixtures, low voltage devices, or other electrical devices of various known types (not shown)), from the support structure (not shown). The electrical box assembly **100** may further house one or more conductors (not shown), arranged for electrical connection to the relevant electrical devices or other devices exterior to the assembly **100**.

[0039] Referring to FIG. **2**, the electrical box **104** includes an electrical box housing **124** and an extendable sleeve **128**. The electrical box housing **124** has a front opening **132** and a rear wall **136** opposite the front opening **132**. A set of housing tabs extend inward into the electrical box housing **124** from a first sidewall **148** and a second sidewall **152** (e.g., illustrated in FIG. **3** as a first housing tab **140** and a second housing tab **144**). The first and second sidewalls **148**, **152** may be opposing sidewalls of the electrical box **104**. A first housing tab **140** may extend from the first sidewall **148**, and a second housing tab **144** may extend from the second sidewall **152**, so that the housing tabs **140**, **144** are also on opposing sides of the electrical box **104**. In some embodiments, a third housing tab **145** may extend from the first sidewall **148** and may be spaced from the first housing tab **140** in a direction that is parallel to the first sidewall **148**. Likewise, a fourth housing tab **146** may extend from the second sidewall **152** and may be spaced from the second housing tab **144** in a direction that is parallel to the second sidewall **152**. Although the three-device rectangular configuration of the electrical box **104** of FIG. **2** may be particularly useful in some contexts, other examples can have other shapes (e.g., round, square, octagonal etc.) and sizes (e.g., two-device, or otherwise), including as further discussed below.

[0040] In some embodiments, the first and second housing tabs **140**, **144** may be directly opposite each other (i.e., an axis extending perpendicular to the first sidewall **148** may intersect or bisect both the first housing tab **140** and the second housing tab **144**). Additionally, the third and fourth housing tabs **145**, **146** may be positioned directly opposite each other. In other configurations, the first and second housing tabs **140**, **144** (e.g., and the third and fourth housing tabs **145**, **146**) may not be directly opposite each other. Furthermore, as illustrated in FIG. **3** the first and second housing tabs **140**, **144** can be separated from the knockouts, in a direction that extends away from the rear wall **136** (i.e., along the adjustment direction of the assembly). The separation can prevent potential interference with electrical conductors entering and leaving the electrical box **104**.

[0041] The housing tabs **140**, **144**, **145**, **146** may be configured to retain threaded adjustment fasteners **156** and permit rotation of the adjustment fasteners **156** but not translation relative to the electrical box housing **124**. For example, the adjustment fasteners **156** can be rotatable relative to the housing tabs **140**, **144**, **145**, **146** but can be translationally (axially) fixed relative to the housing tabs **140**, **144**, **145**, **146** (e.g., via riveting or peening of the fasteners, use of E-, C-, or other clips, use of integral or removable collars, or other techniques).

[0042] Referring again to FIG. **2**, the extendable sleeve **128** is configured to be received through the front opening **132** of the electrical box housing **124** and movable relative thereto. In this regard, it may be understood that the extendable sleeve **128** does not provide an extendable mud ring but is rather part of an electrical box that can itself be extended. In particular, the extendable sleeve **128** includes a set of sleeve tabs. The set of sleeve tabs may include a first sleeve tab **160**, a second sleeve tab **161**, a third sleeve tab **162**, and a fourth sleeve tab **163**.

[0043] Referring briefly to FIG. **7**, during assembly, respective sleeve tabs **160**, **161**, **162**, **163** may be aligned with respective housing tabs **140**, **144**, **145**, **146** so that respective sets of sleeve tabs and housing tabs (e.g., a set such as the first sleeve tab **160** and the first housing tab **140**) can cooperatively receive an adjustment fastener **156**. As such, each set of respective sleeve tabs and housing tabs includes one of the adjustment fasteners **156** extending therethrough. The sleeve tabs **160**, **161**, **162**, **163** are threaded and configured to threadably receive the adjustment fasteners **156** so that the adjustment fasteners **156** couple the extendable sleeve **128** to the electrical box housing **124**.

[0044] Referring again to FIG. **2**, adjustment (e.g., rotation) of the adjustment fasteners **156** can translate the extendable sleeve **128** along an adjustment axis **166** extending perpendicularly through a center point of the rear wall **136** of the electrical box housing. The extendable sleeve **128** also includes a sleeve front opening **168** and mounting tabs **172** extending inward into the sleeve front opening **168** that are, respectively, configured to receive device fasteners (not shown) to secure electrical devices to the extendable sleeve **128** (e.g., to receive and secure electrical outlets, switches, or other known electrical devices, etc.).

[0045] Referring to FIG. **3**, as discussed above, during the manufacturing of the electrical box assembly **100** it may be important to ensure proper alignment of the sets of housing tabs with the sets of sleeve tabs. To increase accuracy and precision relative to conventional approaches, the housing tabs **140**, **144**, **145**, **146** may be integrally formed with the first and second sidewalls **148**, **152**. For example, the housing tabs **140**, **144**, **145**, **146** can be stamped or otherwise cut from the first and second sidewalls **148**, **152**, and bent toward an inside of the electrical box housing **124**. Stamping or otherwise cutting the housing tabs **140**, **144**, **145**, **146** can be a machine-controlled process that increases placement accuracy and precision of the housing tabs **140**, **144**, **145**, **146**. Further, such an approach may not rely on a welder or other operator to estimate a fastened position or orientation of the housing tabs **140**, **144**, **145**, **146**. The housing tabs **140**, **144**, **145**, **146** that extend integrally from first and second sidewalls **148**, **152** of the electrical box housing **124** may also advantageously reduce interference with the electrical conductors entering and leaving the electrical box **104**, while mitigating obstruction to the movement of the extendable sleeve **128**.

[0046] Referring to FIGS. **3** and **5**, in particular, stamping or otherwise cutting the first and second housing tabs **140**, **144** from the first and second sidewalls **148**, **152** may form holes in the first and second sidewalls **148**, **152**. For example, the stamping or cutting of the first and second housing tabs **140**, **144** may form a first and second hole **184**, **188** adjacent to the first and second housing tabs **140**, **144** respectively. In this regard, for example, the tabs **140**, **144** may sometimes extend integrally from an edge of the corresponding hole **184**, **188** that results from formation of the tab **140**, **144**.

[0047] As illustrated in FIG. **3**, the stamping or cutting of the first and second housing tabs **140**, **144** may result in the first and second holes **184**, **188** disposed on a first side of the first and second housing tabs **140**, **144** nearest the front opening **132** of the electrical box housing **124** (i.e., between the tabs **140**, **144** and the front opening **132**). Forming the housing tabs **140**, **144** such that the holes **184**, **188** are disposed on the first side of the first and second housing tabs **140**, **144** may reduce interference to the knockouts and other components of the housing **124** caused by the housing tabs **140**, **144**. For example, the housing tabs **140**, **144**, having the holes **184**, **188** positioned on the first side of the housing tabs **140**, **144**, may be positioned closer to the knockouts without the holes **184**, **188** potentially extending into the knockouts or a region between adjacent knockouts. Furthermore, as discussed below, covers or plates that may be used to cover the holes **184**, **188** that are disposed on the first side of the first and second housing tabs **140**, **144** may be positioned farther from the knockouts, thus reducing potential interference to components extending through the knockouts.

[0048] However, in other configurations, the first and second holes **184**, **188** may instead be disposed on a side of the first and second housing tabs **140**, **144** nearest the rear wall **136** of the electrical box housing **124** (e.g., opposite the first side). Holes may also be formed in the sidewalls **148**, **152** from the stamping or cutting of the third and fourth housing tabs **145**, **146**, resulting in third and fourth holes **189**, **190**, respectively.

[0049] Referring to FIGS. **6** and **7**, in some embodiments, the first and second holes **184**, **188** may advantageously be covered to appropriately enclose the conductors (not shown) within the electrical box assembly **100**. For example, applicable standards may not permit uncovered holes in sidewalls of electrical boxes. As illustrated in FIG. **6**, the first and second holes **184**, **188** may each be covered by a cover (e.g., a separate cover plate, a portion of a component of the assembly **100**, or other cover as described further below). As will be described further below, covers may be secured to the electrical box assembly using a variety of techniques including welding (e.g., spot welding), riveting, bolting, press or friction fitting, or other known fastening techniques.

[0050] Still referring to FIG. **6**, a first and second cover **192**, **196** (e.g., cover plate) may contact the sidewalls **148**, **152** of the electrical box housing **124** to cover or close the first and second holes **184**, **188**, respectively. The first and second covers **192**, **196** may be welded (e.g., spot welded) to an exterior of the electrical box housing **124** to cover the first and second holes **184**, **188**, respectively. Spot welding the first and second covers **192**, **196** to an exterior of the first and second sidewalls **148**, **152** may mitigate obstruction to the movement of the extendable sleeve **128** along an interior of the electrical box housing and to electrical components within the housing.

[0051] Positioning the covers **192**, **196** along an exterior of the sidewalls **148**, **152** may improve access and visibility during the installation of the covers **192**, **196**, allowing manufacturers to attach the covers **192**, **196** without hindrance from other components of the assembly **100**, such as the housing tabs **140**, **144**, or from the need to work within the confined spaces of the inside of the housing **124**. Furthermore, positioning the covers **192**, **196** along an exterior of the sidewalls **148**, **152** may ensure an entirety of holes **184**, **188** are covered by the respective covers **192**, **196**, while positioning the covers **192**, **196** along an interior of the sidewalls **148**, **152** may be challenging due to potential obstructions caused by the housing tabs or an irregularity of a profile of the holes **184**, **188** along an interior surface of the sidewalls **148**, **152**. However, in some embodiments, the covers **192**, **196** may instead be positioned along an interior of the sidewalls **148**, **152**.

[0052] As shown, the first and second covers **192**, **196** can be similarly sized and shaped, and discussion of either of the covers **192**, **196** can correspondingly apply to the other. However, in some examples, differently sized, shaped, or otherwise configured covers (e.g., cover plates) are possible.

[0053] In some examples, the first cover **192** may extend along the first sidewall **148** to cover both the first hole **184**, and the third hole **189**. Likewise, the second cover **196** may extend along the second wall **152** to cover both the second hole **188** and the fourth hole **190**. However, in other embodiments, the holes **184**, **188**, **189**, **190** may each be covered by a separate cover that is spot welded, or otherwise secured, to the housing **124**.

[0054] Referring to FIG. **8**, in order to ensure the conductors (not shown) within the electrical box assembly **100** are properly protected, the first and second covers **192**, **196** may each be a thickness **200** that is at least 0.0625 inches. For example, a cover plate having a minimum thickness of 0.0625 inches may comply with various applicable standards.

[0055] In other configurations, covers can be secured to sidewalls of an electrical box housing (and an electric box, in general) in other ways. In this regard, for example, FIGS. **9-11** illustrate another embodiment of an electrical box assembly **300**. The electrical box assembly **300** of FIGS. **9-11** may generally include similar features as the electrical box assembly **100** of FIGS. **1-8**, including but not limited to an electrical box **304**, an electrical box housing **324**, an extendable sleeve (not shown), a front opening **332**, a rear wall **336**, a first housing tab **340**, a second housing tab **344**, a third housing tab **345**, a fourth housing tab **346**, a first sidewall **348**, a second sidewall **352**, adjustment fasteners (not shown), a first sleeve tab (not shown), a second sleeve tab (not shown), a housing axis **366**, a first hole **380**, a second hole **384**, a third hole **385**, a fourth hole **386**, first cover (e.g., plate) **392**, and a second cover (e.g., plate) **396**. Thus, discussion of the electrical box assembly **100** above also generally applies to similar components of the electrical box assembly **300** (and vice versa).

[0056] In some aspects, the electrical box assemblies **100** and **300** may differ. For example, the first and second covers **392**, **396** may be secured to the electrical box housing **324** via arms that extend from the first and second sidewalls **348**, **352**. Referring to FIG. **9**, a first set of arms **400** and a second set of arms **404** (see FIG. **10**) may extend integrally from the first and second sidewalls **348**, **352** respectively. The first and second sets of arms **400**, **404** may mechanically secure the first and second covers **392**, **396**, respectively. As illustrated, the first set of arms **400** are configured similarly to the second set of arms **404**, and discussion of the arms **404** thus also applies to the arms **400**. In other examples, however, different sets of arms can be configured differently.

[0057] In different examples, different numbers or orientations of one or more arms can be included for particular holes on an electric box. For example, as illustrated in FIG. **9**, the second set of arms **404** may include a first arm **408** and a second arm **412** that may be stamped or otherwise cut from the second sidewall **352** during the stamping or cutting of the second housing tab **344**. The first arm **408** and the second arm **412** may be disposed on opposite ends of the second hole **384**, and may extend in a direction that is parallel (or substantially parallel) to the housing axis **366** of the electrical box housing **324**.

[0058] As illustrated in FIG. **9**, the first arm **408** may extend integrally from the second sidewall **352** at a first arm end **416**. The first arm **408** may extend from the first arm end **416** to a second arm free end **420** that is disconnected from the second sidewall **352**. A first gap **424** may be formed between an exterior side of the second sidewall **352** and the second arm free end **420**. The second arm **412** may similarly be integrally formed to extend from a third arm end **428** to a fourth arm free end **432** to form a second gap **436**. The arms **408**, **412** thus provide discrete channel structures into which the cover **396** can be slid (e.g., along or transverse to the housing axis **366**). The second cover **396**, once received into the first and second gaps **424**, **436** may be secured against the second sidewall **352** by the first arm **408** and the second arm **412**.

[0059] As illustrated in FIGS. **9** and **10**, the first and second gaps **424**, **436** may open toward a same direction as the front opening **332** of the electrical box housing **324**. In other embodiments, the first and second gaps **424**, **436** may alternatively open toward a direction opposite the front opening **332**, or the first and second gaps **424**, **436** may open in different directions.

[0060] In some embodiments, prior to receiving the second cover **396** the first gap **424** and the second gap **436** may each define a maximum width that is less than a width of the second cover **396**. During installation of the second cover **396**, the first arm and the second arm **408**, **412** may be partially deformed (e.g., flexed elastically away from the sidewalls **348**, **352**) to receive the second cover **396**. The deformation of the first and second arms **408**, **412** may further aid the securement of the second cover **396** to the electrical box housing **324** via the resilient response of the arms **408**, **412** to the deformation.

[0061] In some embodiments, the second cover **396** may be further secured by crimping or otherwise deforming the first set of arms **400** toward the second sidewall **352**. Such an inward deformation of the second set of arms **404** may increase the mechanical engagement between the second cover **396**, the second sidewall **352**, and the second set of arms **404**. Thus, for example, the deformed arms **404** may help to ensure that the second cover **396** is not unseated or otherwise moved during and after installation of the electrical box assembly **300** (e.g., as may eliminate the need for any welding of the cover **396**).

[0062] In some embodiments, the first cover **392** may be secured over the first hole **380** using the first set of arms **400**. The first set of arms **400** may function similarly to the second set of arms **404** described above. In some embodiments, other configurations of the first and second sets of arms **400**, **404** are possible. In some embodiments, the first and second covers **392**, **396** may extend to cover the third and fourth holes **385**, **386** respectively, and the first and second sets of arms **400**, **404** may be reconfigured accordingly (e.g., the first and second set of arms **400**, **404** may include an arm positioned at either end of the first and second covers **392**, **396**, respectively). In some examples, third and fourth sets of arms **440**, **444** (e.g., adjacent the third and fourth holes **385**, **386**) may cooperate with the first and second sets of arms **400**, **404**, respectively to secure the first and second covers **392**, **396**, respectively, to cover the third and fourth holes **385**, **386**, respectively. In other examples, the third and fourth set of arms **440**, **444** may secure third and fourth covers (e.g., plates) **448**, **452** to cover the third and fourth holes **385**, **386**, respectively. The third and fourth sets of arms **440**, **444** may be shaped and may function similarly to the first and second sets of arms **400**, **404**.

[0063] As another example, FIGS. **12**-**14**B illustrate another embodiment of an electrical box assembly **500**. The electrical box assembly **500** of FIGS. **12**-**14**B may generally include similar features as the electrical box assembly **100** of FIGS. **1**-**8** including but not limited to an electrical box **504**, a centerplate **508**, a plate body **512**, an electrical box housing **524**, an extendable sleeve not shown), a front opening **532**, a rear wall **536**, a first housing tab **540**, a second housing tab **544**, a third housing tab **545**, a fourth housing tab **546**, a first sidewall **548**, a second sidewall **552**, adjustment fasteners (not shown), a first sleeve tab (not shown), a second sleeve tab (not shown), a first hole **580**, a second hole **584**, a third hole **586**, a fourth hole **588**, a first cover (e.g., plate) **592**, a second cover (e.g., plate) **594**, a third cover (e.g., plate) **596**, and a fourth cover (not shown). Thus, discussion of the electrical box assembly **100** above also generally applies to similar components of the electrical box assembly **500** (and vice versa).

[0064] Referring to FIGS. **12** through **14**, in some aspects, the electrical box assemblies **100** and **500** may differ. For example, as shown in FIGS. **14**A and **14**B the first and second holes **580**, **584** disposed in the first and second sidewalls **548**, **552**, respectively, may be covered by a portion of the centerplate **508** (e.g., instead of a directly seated plate similar to the plates **392**, **396** discussed above). In some embodiments, the centerplate **508** may include a set of plate arms, including at least a first plate arm **600** and a second plate arm **604**. The plate arms may extend at least partially along sidewalls of the electrical box housing **524** to secure the electrical box **504** to the centerplate **508** (e.g., via various spot welds), and to at least partially surround the electrical box **504**. As illustrated in FIG. **13**, the first plate arm **600** may extend along an exterior of the first sidewall **548** of the electrical box housing **524**. Furthermore, as illustrated in FIG. **14**A, the second plate arm **604** may extend along an exterior of the second sidewall **552** of the electrical box housing **524**.

[0065] Referring again to FIG. **13**, in the example shown, the centerplate **508** defines a first portion and a second portion that are integrally connected and also separable by a break feature (e.g., a continuous score line as shown) so as to allow the centerplate **508** to be selectively broken into two pieces for particular installations. In other examples, a single plate arm or more than two plate arms may extend across a similar span of a box sidewall (e.g., including so as to cover one or more holes corresponding to housing tabs).

[0066] Referring to FIGS. **13** and **14**A, in some examples, the first and second covers **592**, **594** (e.g., cover plates) may be integral with one or more of the plate arms **600**, **604**. For example, focusing on the first cover **592**, a region of the first plate arm **600** may define the first cover **592**, and may cover or close the first hole **580**. Specifically, the first cover **592** can be integrally formed with the first plate arm **600**. In some examples, the first plate arm **600** may define a thickness of at least 0.0625 inches thick, such that the first cover **592** is able to properly close the first hole **580**. In other examples, the region of the plate arm **600** defining the first cover **592** may be locally thickened to at least 0.0625 inches thick, while the rest of the plate arm **600** is less than 0.0625 inches thick. Similarly, the second cover **594** may define a region of the second plate arm **604**, so that the second cover **594** can be integrally formed with the second plate arm **604**. The second cover **594** may cover the second hole **584** and may also define a thickness that is at least 0.0625 inches thick.

[0067] In some examples, increased material thickness may be included on a plate arm of a centerplate to cover the relevant hole(s). For example, in some embodiments, the plate arms **600**, **604** of the centerplate **508**, and thus the first cover **592** and the second cover **594** may be less than 0.0625 inches thick. Correspondingly, in some examples, to increase a thickness of the first cover **592** and the second cover **594**, a separate cover plate may be secured to the plate arms **600**, **604**.

[0068] Referring to FIGS. **14**A-B, in some embodiments, a first cover plate **608** may be welded to the first plate arm **600** to increase a thickness of the region of the first plate arm **600** defining the first cover **592** and thus covering the first hole **580**. For example, in an installed configuration, the first cover plate **608** may be situated over the first hole **580**. Furthermore, in an installed configuration, the first cover plate **608** may be disposed on an opposite side of the plate arm **600** (e.g., the first cover **592**) from the first outer sidewall **548**. This configuration may case installation of the first cover plate **608**, and may reduce obstruction between the centerplate **508** (e.g., the first plate arm **600**) and the housing **524**.

[0069] As illustrated in FIG. **14**B, a thickness **612** of a combination of the first cover **592** of the first plate arm **600** and the first cover plate **608** may be greater than or equal to 0.0625 inches. As illustrated in FIG. **14**A, the second hole **584** may similarly be covered by a combination of the second cover **594** of the second plate arm **604** and a second cover plate **616** secured to the second cover **594** (e.g., via welding), or may be otherwise configured. Additionally, the third and fourth covers (not shown in FIG. **14**A) may be integrally formed or otherwise attached to the second plate arm **604**. As such, the third and fourth holes **586**, **588** (not shown in FIG. **14**A) may be covered by a combination of the third cover **596** and the fourth cover, respectively, (not shown in FIG. **14**A) and a third cover plate **620** and a fourth cover plate, respectively, (not shown in FIG. **14**A) secured to the third cover **596** and the fourth cover (e.g., via welding), or may be otherwise configured.

[0070] In some configurations, locating features can be included on a centerplate for cover plates. For example, as shown in FIG. **13**, U-shaped imprints or other features (e.g., embosses) can be provided to help align the cover plates **608**, **616** relative to the covers **592**, **594** and the plate arms **600**, **604** during manufacturing.

[0071] FIGS. **15**-**16**B illustrate another embodiment of an electrical box assembly **700**. The electrical box assembly **700** of FIGS. **15**-**16**B may generally include similar features as the electrical box assembly **500** of FIGS. **12**-**14**B, including but not limited to an electrical box **704**, a centerplate **708**, a plate body **712**, an electrical box housing **724**, an extendable sleeve (not shown), a front opening **732**, a rear wall **736**, a first housing tab **740**, a second housing tab **744**, a first sidewall **748**, a second sidewall **752**, adjustment fasteners (not shown), a first sleeve tab (not shown), a second sleeve tab (not shown), a first hole **780**, a second hole **784**, a third hole (not shown), a fourth hole (not shown), a first cover **792**, a second cover **794**, a third cover **796**, a fourth cover (not shown), a first plate arm **800**, and a second plate arm **804**. Thus, discussion of the electrical box assembly **100** above also generally applies to similar components of the electrical box assembly **500** (and vice versa).

[0072] In some aspects, the electrical box assemblies **500** and **700** may differ. For example, after installation of the centerplate **708** onto the electrical box **704**, the first hole **780** and the second hole (not shown) disposed in the first and second sidewalls **748**, **752**, respectively, may only be covered by portions of the centerplates **708** (e.g., the first cover **792** and the second cover **794**). However, to increase a thickness of the first cover **792** and the second cover **794** covering the first and second holes **780**, **784**, respectively, the plate arms **800**, **804** may include tabs that extend integrally from the plate arms **800**, **804** (e.g., from the first cover **792** and the second cover **794**). The tabs may accordingly be folded to cover the first and second holes **780**, **784**, and thereby locally increase the thickness of the covering material (i.e., so that two layers of material of the plate arms—including at least a respective one of the tabs covering each of the first cover **792** and the second cover **794**—cover each of the first and second holes **780**, **784**) (as also shown in FIG. **15**B). For example, as illustrated in FIGS. **16**A-B, the first plate arm **800** may define the first cover **792** that covers the first hole **780** and a first tab **808** may be folded to cover the first cover **792** (e.g., the area of the first plate arm **800** covering the first hole **780**).

[0073] As illustrated in FIG. **16**B, a thickness **812** of a combination of the first cover **792** of the first plate arm **800** and the first tab **808** covering the first hole **780** may be greater than or equal to 0.0625 inches. As illustrated in FIG. **16**A, the second hole **784** may similarly be covered by a combination of the second cover **794** of the second plate arm **804** and a second tab **816**, or may be otherwise configured. Additionally, the third and fourth covers (not shown in FIG. **14**A) may be integrally formed or otherwise attached to the second plate arm **804**. As such, the third and fourth holes (not shown in FIG. **16**A) may also be covered by a combination of the third cover **796** and the fourth cover, respectively, (not shown in FIG. **16**A) and a third **820** and fourth tab, respectively, (not shown in FIG. **16**A) that extend integrally from the second plate arm **804**, or may be otherwise configured.

[0074] In some configurations, an electrical box assembly may include a differently configured housing or extendable sleeve to accommodate other types of electrical components (e.g., low voltage and other electrical devices, etc.) or other needs of particular installations. In this regard, for example, FIGS. **17**A and **17**B illustrate another embodiment of an electrical box assembly **900**. The electrical box assembly **900** of FIGS. **17**A and **17**B may generally include similar features as the electrical box assemblies **100**, **300**, **500**, **700** of FIGS. **1-16**B, including but not limited to an electrical box **904**, a centerplate **908**, a plate body **912**, an electrical box housing **924**, an extendable sleeve **928**, a front opening **932**, a rear wall **936**, a first housing tab **940**, a second housing tab **944**, a first sidewall **948**, a second sidewall **952**, adjustment fasteners **956**, a first sleeve tab **960**, and a second sleeve tab **964**. Thus, discussion of the electrical box assembly **100**, **300**, **500**, **700** above also generally applies to similar components of the electrical box assembly **900** (and vice versa).

[0075] In some aspects, the electrical box assemblies **100**, **300**, **500**, and **700** and the electrical box assembly **900** may differ. For example, the electrical box assembly **900** of FIGS. **17**A and **17**B may include the electrical box housing **924** and extendable sleeve **928** that have an elongated rectangular perimeter. As above, the first sidewall **948** may include the first housing tab **940**. Furthermore, the second sidewall **952** may include the second housing tab **940**. As illustrated in FIGS. **17**A and **17**B, the electrical box housing can include four or more housing tabs. As above, a hole may be disposed adjacent to each of the four or more housing tabs. The holes of FIGS. **17**A and **17**B may be covered using covers (e.g., cover plates or tabs) according to any of the examples discussed above in relation to the electrical box assemblies **100**, **300**, **500**, and **700**.

[0076] In some embodiments, the centerplate **908** may be controllably breakable into two or more portions. For example, the centerplate **908** may be breakable (or be otherwise manufactured to include) a first portion **1000** and a second portion **1004**. The first portion **1000** may be a first half of the centerplate **908**, and the second portion **1004** may be a second half of the centerplate **908**. As illustrated, the first and second portions **1000**, **1004** may be substantially identical and symmetrically arranged, although other configurations are possible. Each of the first and second portions **1000**, and **1004** may surround at least a portion of a perimeter of the electrical box **904** and correspondingly may cover holes in the electrical box **904** as similarly discussed above. In some examples, separate cover plates can be used to cover holes in the electrical box **904** (e.g., as also discussed above).

[0077] The discussion above is framed relative to particular electrical box assemblies and associated arrangements. However, those of skill in the art will recognize that this discussion implicitly also discloses various methods of adjustably mounting electrical boxes relative to support structures. Similarly, as also discussed above, the particular configurations of the boxes and other components expressly described and illustrated in the various embodiments are presented as examples only, and the concepts disclosed herein can be used to adjustably secure electrical boxes (or other components) relative to a variety of bracket configurations and support structures. Further, specific features discussed in detail relative to certain embodiments can be generally configured or used similarly with other embodiments, including relative to similar features on those embodiments or as substitutions or additions to those embodiments.

[0078] Thus, examples of the disclosed technology can provide improved systems for installing electrical box assemblies for suspending electrical components and fixtures. Some examples provide a depth adjustable electrical box assembly that is inexpensive to manufacture while providing an improved mechanism for aligning tabs of the electrical box that receive adjustment fasteners to adjust a depth of the electrical box.

[0079] It is to be understood that the phraseology and terminology used herein is for the purpose of description and should not be regarded as limiting. The use of “including,” “comprising,” or “having” and variations thereof herein is meant to encompass the items listed thereafter and equivalents thereof as well as additional items. Unless specified or limited otherwise, the terms “mounted,” “connected,” “supported,” and “coupled” and variations thereof are used broadly and encompass both direct and indirect mountings, connections, supports, and couplings. Further, “connected” and “coupled” are not restricted to physical or mechanical connections or couplings.

[0080] Also as used herein, ordinal numbers are used for convenience of presentation only and are generally presented in an order that corresponds to the order in which particular features are introduced in the relevant discussion. Accordingly, for example, a “first” feature may not necessarily have any required structural or sequential relationship to a “second” feature, and so on. Further, similar features may be referred to in different portions of the discussion by different ordinal numbers. For example, a particular feature may be referred to in some discussion as a “first” feature, while a similar or substantially identical feature may be referred to in other discussion as a “third” feature, and so on.

[0081] Also as used herein, unless otherwise limited or defined, “integral” and derivatives thereof (e.g., “integrally”) describe elements that are manufactured as a single piece without fasteners, adhesive, or the like to secure separate components together. For example, an element stamped, cast, or otherwise molded as a single-piece component from a single piece of sheet metal or using a single mold, without rivets, screws, or adhesive to hold separately formed pieces together is an integral (and integrally formed) element. In contrast, an element formed from multiple pieces that are separately formed initially then later connected together, is not an integral (or integrally formed) element.

[0082] Unless otherwise limited or defined, the terms “about” and “approximately,” as used herein with respect to a reference value, refer to variations from the reference value of ±20% or less (e.g., ±15, ±10%, ±5%, etc.), inclusive of the endpoints of the range. Similarly, as used herein with respect to a reference value, the term “substantially equal” (and the like) refers to variations from the reference value of less than ±5% (e.g., ±2%, ±1%, ±0.5%) inclusive. Ranges as provide herein are inclusive of endpoints unless otherwise specified.

[0083] Unless otherwise limited or defined, “substantially parallel” indicates a direction that is within ±12 degrees of a reference direction (e.g., within ±6 degrees or ±3 degrees), inclusive. Correspondingly, “substantially vertical” indicates a direction that is substantially parallel to the vertical direction, as defined relative to gravity, with a similarly derived meaning for “substantially horizontal” (relative to the horizontal direction). Likewise, unless otherwise limited or defined, “substantially perpendicular” indicates a direction that is within ±12 degrees of perpendicular a reference direction (e.g., within ±6 degrees or ±3 degrees), inclusive. Likewise, unless otherwise limited or defined, “substantially radial” indicates a direction that is within ±12 degrees of radial a reference direction (e.g., within ±6 degrees or ±3 degrees), inclusive. Likewise, unless otherwise limited or defined, "substantially axial" indicates a direction that is within ±12 degrees of axial a reference direction (e.g., within ±6 degrees or ±3 degrees), inclusive.

[0084] Also as used herein, unless otherwise limited or defined, "or" indicates a non-exclusive list of components or operations that can be present in any variety of combinations, rather than an exclusive list of components that can be present only as alternatives to each other. For example, a list of "A, B, or C" indicates options of: A; B; C; A and B; A and C; B and C; and A, B, and C. Correspondingly, the term "or" as used herein is intended to indicate exclusive alternatives only when preceded by terms of exclusivity, such as "only one of," or "exactly one of." For example, a list of "only one of A, B, or C" indicates options of: A, but not B and C; B, but not A and C; and C, but not A and B. In contrast, a list preceded by "one or more" (and variations thereon) and including "or" to separate listed elements indicates options of one or more of any or all of the listed elements. For example, the phrases "one or more of A, B, or C" and "at least one of A, B, or C" indicate options of: one or more A; one or more B; one or more C; one or more A and one or more B; one or more B and one or more C; one or more A and one or more C; and one or more A, one or more B, and one or more C. Similarly, a list preceded by "a plurality of" (and variations thereon) and including "or" to separate listed elements indicates options of one or more of each of multiple of the listed elements. For example, the phrases "a plurality of A, B, or C" and "two or more of A, B, or C" indicate options of: one or more A and one or more B; one or more B and one or more C; one or more A and one or more C; and one or more A, one or more B, and one or more C.

[0085] Also as used herein, unless otherwise specified or limited, directional terms are presented only with regard to the particular embodiment and perspective described. For example, reference to features or directions as "horizontal," "vertical," "front," "rear," "left," "right," and so on are generally made with reference to a particular figure or example and are not necessarily indicative of an absolute orientation or direction. However, relative directional terms for a particular embodiment may generally apply to alternative orientations of that embodiment. For example, "front" and "rear" directions or features (or "right" and "left" directions or features, and so on) may be generally understood to indicate relatively opposite directions or features.

[0086] In some implementations, devices or systems disclosed herein can be utilized, manufactured, installed, etc. using methods embodying aspects of the disclosed technology. Correspondingly, any description herein of particular features, capabilities, or intended purposes of a device or system should be considered to disclose, as examples of the disclosed technology a method of using such devices for the intended purposes, a method of otherwise implementing such capabilities, a method of manufacturing relevant components of such a device or system (or the device or system as a whole), and a method of installing disclosed (or otherwise known) components to support such purposes or capabilities. Similarly, unless otherwise indicated or limited, discussion herein of any method of manufacturing or using for a particular device or system, including installing the device or system, should be understood to disclose, as examples of the disclosed technology, the utilized features and implemented capabilities of such device or system.

[0087] The previous description of the disclosed embodiments is provided to enable any person skilled in the art to make or use the invention. Various modifications to these embodiments will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art, and the generic principles defined herein may be applied to other embodiments without departing from the spirit or scope of the invention. Thus, the invention is not intended to be limited to the embodiments shown herein but is to be accorded the widest scope consistent with the principles and novel features disclosed herein.

What is claimed is:

1. An adjustable-depth electrical box assembly, the assembly comprising:

an adjustable-depth electrical box that includes:

a housing including:

outer sidewalls extending from a base end to an open end of the housing, the outer sidewalls including a first outer sidewall; and

a first housing tab extending integrally from the first outer sidewall, with a first hole disposed in the first outer sidewall, adjacent the first housing tab;

an extendable sleeve including sleeve walls and a first sleeve tab;

the outer sidewalls slidably receiving the extendable sleeve;

a first cover contacting an exterior of the first outer sidewall to close the first hole; and

an adjustment fastener extending through the first housing tab and the first sleeve tab and rotatable to adjust a depth of the extendable sleeve relative to the housing.

2. The assembly of claim **1**, wherein the first housing tab is a stamped or cut tab and the first hole is resultant from the stamping or cutting of the first housing tab in the first outer sidewall.

3. The assembly of claim **1**, wherein the first cover is a first plate secured to the exterior of the first outer sidewall.

4. The assembly of claim **3**, wherein the first plate is spot welded to the first outer sidewall.

5. The assembly of claim **3**, wherein the first outer sidewall further includes arms that secure the first plate against the first outer sidewall.

6. The assembly of claim **1**, further comprising:

a centerplate that surrounds and supports the adjustable-depth electrical box;

wherein the first cover includes a first plate arm of the centerplate.

7. The assembly of claim **6**, wherein the first cover further includes a first plate that is welded to the first plate arm on an opposite side of the first plate arm from the first outer sidewall.

8. The assembly of claim **6**, wherein the first cover further includes a tab extending integrally from the first plate arm to cover the first hole.

9. The assembly of claim **1**, wherein the first hole is disposed between the open end of the housing and the first housing tab.

10. The assembly of claim **1**, wherein the outer sidewalls further include a second outer sidewall opposite the first outer sidewall;

wherein the housing further includes a second housing tab extending integrally from the second outer sidewall, with a second hole disposed in the second outer sidewall, adjacent the first housing tab; and wherein a second cover contacts an exterior of the second outer sidewall to close the second hole.

11. An adjustable-depth electrical box assembly, the assembly comprising:

an adjustable-depth electrical box that includes:

a housing including:

outer sidewalls extending from a base end to an open end of the housing, the outer sidewalls including a first outer sidewall;

a first housing tab stamped from the first outer sidewall; and

a first hole resultant from the stamping of the first housing tab from the first outer sidewall;

a first cover plate contacting the first outer sidewall to close the first hole;

an extendable sleeve; and

a fastener extending through the first housing tab to adjust the extendable sleeve relative to the housing.

12. The assembly of claim **11**, wherein a pair of arms extend integrally from the first outer sidewall to secure the first cover plate against the first outer sidewall.

13. The assembly of claim **11**, further comprising:

a centerplate that surrounds and supports the adjustable-depth electrical box;

wherein the centerplate includes the first cover plate.

14. The assembly of claim **13**, wherein the first cover plate is integral with a first plate arm of the centerplate.

15. The assembly of claim **13**, wherein a second cover plate is welded to the first cover plate on an opposite side of the centerplate from the first outer sidewall.

16. The assembly of claim **13**, wherein the first cover plate further includes a tab extending from the centerplate, wherein the tab is folded over to form a first layer and a second layer of the first cover plate.

17. The assembly of claim **11**, wherein the first cover plate contacts an exterior surface of the first outer sidewall.

18. A method of assembling an adjustable-depth electrical box, the method comprising:

forming a housing with a housing tab integrally formed with a sidewall of the housing;

closing a hole disposed adjacent the housing tab with a cover that contacts the housing;

aligning an extendable sleeve to be inserted into the housing, so that the housing tab is aligned with a sleeve tab of the extendable sleeve; and

installing an adjustment fastener to extend through the housing tab and the sleeve tab to adjust the extendable sleeve relative to the housing.

19. The method of claim **18**, wherein closing the hole includes securing the cover to the housing via one of: welding or arms extending from the housing.

20. The method of claim **18** further including, securing a centerplate to the adjustable-depth electrical box, wherein the cover includes a first plate arm of the centerplate.

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